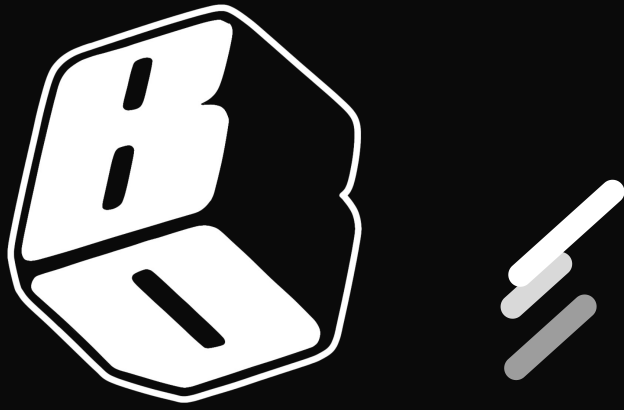




HABIB CORE®

BRAND IDENTITY SYSTEM — FOUNDATION · EXPRESSION · EXPERIMENTATION

A complete identity system built around the existing HABIBCORE mark — one folded-plane symbol carrying a practice that spans design, software, AI systems and operations. This document defines the strategy, visual language, motion, voice and applications that make those disciplines read as one practice, not many services.

POSITIONING

DESIGN + BUILD +
SYSTEMS + EXECUTION

PRACTICE

INDEPENDENT,
MULTIDISCIPLINARY

OPERATING SINCE

2020 —
LAGOS → WORLDWIDE

DOCUMENT

FULL MANUAL,
17 PARTS

HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

This manual is organised in seventeen parts, ordered the way the system was engineered: strategy first, the fixed asset second, then the generative language, then delivery. Every major recommendation is written as a **decision record** — decision, rationale, implementation, example, risks — so future revisions can argue with the reasoning, not just the output.

FOUNDATION Fixed. The strategy, the name, the existing mark and the structural rules of the system. Nothing here changes without a full re-consent. Parts 01–02, 13.	EXPRESSION Guided. The visual language, typography, colour, imagery, icons, motion, digital experience, voice and applications that express the foundation. Evolves deliberately. Parts 03–12.	EXPERIMENTATION Loose. Campaign treatments, motion experiments and format probes that must collapse back into the system after use. Time-boxed, never canon. Parts 09 (edges), 14–16 guardrails.
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P01	BRAND STRATEGY	FOUNDATION
P02	LOGO SYSTEM	FOUNDATION
P03	VISUAL DNA	FOUNDATION → EXPRESSION
P04	GRAPHIC SYSTEM	EXPRESSION
P05	TYPOGRAPHY	EXPRESSION
P06	COLOUR	EXPRESSION
P07	IMAGERY	EXPRESSION
P08	ICONOGRAPHY	EXPRESSION
P09	MOTION SYSTEM	EXPRESSION / EXPERIMENT
P10	DIGITAL EXPERIENCE	EXPRESSION
P11	BRAND VOICE	EXPRESSION
P12	APPLICATIONS	EXPRESSION
P13	BRAND ARCHITECTURE	FOUNDATION
P14	ANTI-COPYING RULES	GUARDRAIL
P15	ANTI-SLOP RULES	GUARDRAIL
P16	DECISION GATES	GOVERNANCE

Conventions used throughout: measurements are given in the unit **x** — the height of one capsule dash in the mark — unless a physical or pixel measure is stated. Figures marked FIG. are normative specimens; they show required behaviour, not optional styling. The word **Signal** in orange always marks a state, a rejection or a warning — never decoration. This document is itself set in the system it defines: Archivo and IBM Plex Mono, keyline frames, dash markers, monochrome surfaces. If a page in here violates the rules it states, the rules win — file it as an errata.

PART 01 / 17

FOUNDATION

BRAND STRATEGY

What HABIBCORE is, who it is for, and the territory it occupies. Everything visual in this document is downstream of the twelve commitments made here.

01.1 — BRAND ESSENCE

HABIBCORE is a one-person practice that completes the loop most brands leave open. In the common split, one party imagines the thing, another party builds it, and nobody in particular operates it afterwards. Value leaks at every handoff: intent gets translated into briefs, briefs into tickets, tickets into compromises. HABIBCORE exists to delete those translations. The person who draws the interface ships the interface, wires the automation, trains the assistant, and takes the 2 a.m. call when something breaks.

The essence, compressed to a working phrase: **follow-through**. Not “creativity”, not “innovation” — those words are claimed by everyone and therefore mean nothing. Follow-through is the specific, provable promise that an idea that enters this practice will exit as a working, maintained, answerable reality. The existing mark already says this without words: planes that fold and lock into one structure, a form that is obviously *assembled*, not decorated.

DECISION RECORD — ESSENCE		GATE: ESSENTIAL
DECISION	The brand essence is “follow-through” — design + build + systems + execution delivered by one accountable pair of hands.	
RATIONALE	It is the only claim in this market that is simultaneously distinctive, verifiable in the portfolio, and structurally true of a solo practice. Large agencies cannot credibly claim it; single-skill freelancers cannot deliver it.	
IMPLEMENTATION	Expressed wherever three beats make sense — headlines, section labels, motion — always as a sequence that resolves: draw → build → answer.	
EXAMPLE	“I design it. I build it. I answer for it.” (already live on habibcore.com — retained as the essence in the wild.)	
RISKS	If the portfolio ever shows work that was mostly delegated or unfinished, the claim collapses. Mitigation: only ship case studies with evidence of end-to-end execution.	

01.2 — POSITIONING

HABIBCORE is positioned against three visible camps. Camp one: **graphic designers**, who deliver beautiful artefacts and hand them to someone else to implement. Camp two: **developers and AI consultants**, who ship functioning systems with no authored point of view. Camp three: **agencies**, who sell breadth and deliver coordination overhead. The practice deliberately refuses all three positions. It is not a generalist “creative technologist” either — that title describes a skill set, not a promise.

The positioning statement, for internal use and profiles:

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For founders and teams who need ideas to become working reality, **HABIBCORE** is the independent Lagos-based practice that designs, codes and operates the same system — so nothing is lost between vision and execution, and one person answers for the whole.

Two load-bearing words deserve definition, because vague words are where positioning goes to die.

“**Operates**” means the engagement does not end at launch: automations monitored, assistants retrained, sites maintained — execution is a standing condition, not a phase. “**System**” means any designed thing with behaviour: an identity, a website, a product, a CRM pipeline, a trained model — the unit of work is the working whole, not the deliverable.

01.3 — BRAND PROMISE & PERCEIVED ATTRIBUTES

The promise has three testable clauses. **One**: what is approved in design is what ships in production — no silent translation loss. **Two**: every system delivered comes with its operations story — who monitors it, how it fails, how it is fixed. **Three**: communication is direct — estimates, problems and limits are stated in plain language before they become surprises. Each clause is falsifiable, which is what makes it a promise rather than a slogan.

When the system works, a stranger should perceive, in this order: **precision** (the alignment, the mono metadata, the zero-noise surfaces), **range** (the same hand evident in a logo, a codebase and an ops dashboard), **accountability** (a name and a face on the work, not a collective we), and **origin** (Lagos time, Lagos coordinates — global standard, specific address). Perception of “cheap” or “template” is the failure mode to engineer against; monochrome discipline and structural detail are the defences.

01.4 — PERSONALITY

The personality is **a quiet engineer with taste**: speaks in short declaratives, shows work instead of adjectives, is comfortable with silence in a layout, and lets one controlled burst of energy out per project (the site’s sound player is exactly this — a party hidden inside a technical document). The brand is confident without being loud, human without being casual, technical without being jargonistic. It never begs, never hypes, never uses exclamation marks to manufacture enthusiasm.

THE BRAND FEELS LIKE

THE BRAND NEVER FEELS LIKE

A precision instrument that a person clearly made — machined, weighted, finished	A template, a theme, or an AI content farm — anything infinitely reproducible
A workshop: tools on the wall, evidence of use, honest materials	An agency pitch theatre — decks about decks, mood boards about mood boards
A signed drawing: authored, attributable, answerable	A corporate collective voice — “we”, “solutions”, “passionate about”
Calm confidence — statements, not salesmanship	Hype — futurism for its own sake, buzzwords, gradient-covered anxiety
Lagos-real: resourceful, direct, globally competitive	Exotic “emerging market” framing, or apologetic geography

01.5 — STRATEGIC TENSION

Every strong identity manages a tension instead of resolving it into blandness. HABIBCORE's live tensions, named so they can be steered deliberately:

- 01 **Craft vs. scale.** One pair of hands is the promise and the ceiling. The brand answers by selling systems that compound (templates, automations, trained assistants) rather than hours. Visual rule: layouts must feel produced, not handmade — the contradiction is resolved by engineering, not by hiding the person.
- 02 **Restraint vs. energy.** The monochrome surface is calm; the work underneath (AI, automation, sound) is energetic. The brand answers with a strict budget: calm dominates, one burst per context, then back to silence.
- 03 **Local vs. global.** Lagos coordinates are worn openly while the output standard is international. The brand never codeswitches into apology or exotica; it behaves like any serious global practice that happens to answer in WAT.

01.6 — AUDIENCE

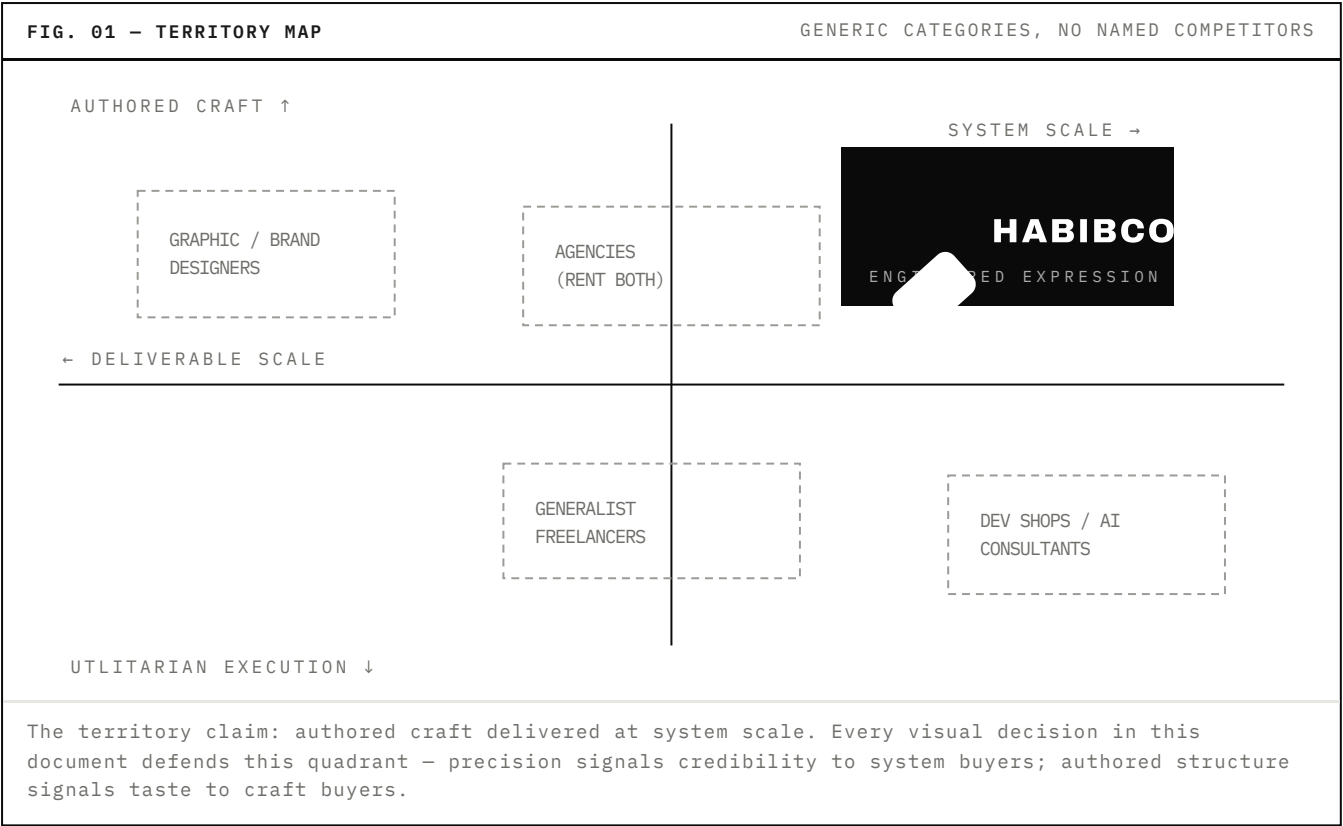
Four buyer archetypes, in priority order. **A — Founders without a team:** pre-seed to Series A operators who need brand, product and tooling from one accountable source and cannot coordinate three vendors. They buy speed and coherence. **B — Product teams with a gap:** companies with engineers but no design authority, or designers but no shipping muscle; HABIBCORE plugs the missing half and hands back the system. **C — Studios and agencies:** creative partners who need a technical organ — white-label builds, automation, AI integration — delivered under their direction. **D — Institutions and cultural clients:** organisations that want AI and software capability introduced with taste, training and governance included.

The portfolio is the primary sales instrument for all four: each archetype must find a case study that mirrors their problem within thirty seconds of landing. This requirement — not decoration — is what shapes the digital experience specified in Part 10.

01.7 — DIFFERENTIATION & TERRITORY

The defensible territory sits where **systemic capability** meets **authored craft**. Most of the market holds one quadrant: designers own craft at deliverable scale; dev shops and AI consultancies own systems with

no point of view; agencies rent both and add coordination cost. HABIBCORE occupies the quadrant that is expensive to fake, because it requires one person to genuinely hold both skill families.



DECISION RECORD – POSITIONING		GATE: ESSENTIAL
DECISION	Own “engineered expression”: the practice positioned as one accountable builder operating across craft and systems, never as a multi-service agency or a job-title freelancer.	
RATIONALE	The category names available (designer, developer, AI consultant) all undersell the loop; the loop itself is the Differentiator. Naming the territory keeps every future service inside one story.	
IMPLEMENTATION	All profiles, bios and proposals lead with the loop (“designs, codes and operates”), then evidence it with three-discipline case studies. Titles like “creative technologist” are banned from profiles (see Part 11).	
EXAMPLE	Site masthead retained: “Habib, Designer & Builder, Lagos” — designer <i>and</i> builder in one title is the positioning in six words.	
RISKS	Positioning breadth can read as “does everything”. Mitigation: the portfolio is organised by proof (shipped systems), and Part 13 locks service naming to eight fixed disciplines.	

LOGO SYSTEM

The existing mark is the fixed asset of this brand. This part does not redesign it — it audits it, specifies every sanctioned presentation, and locks the rules that keep it strong.

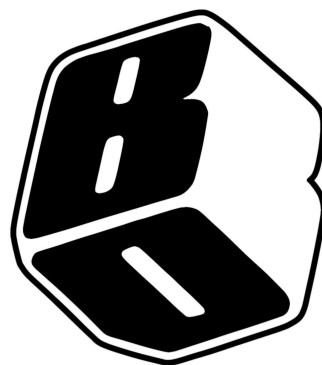
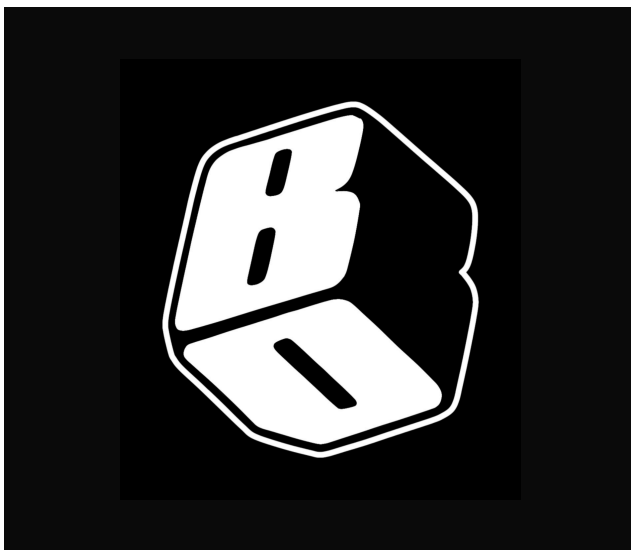
02.1 — AUDIT OF THE EXISTING MARK

The HABIBCORE symbol is a **B constructed as a folded structure**: two white planes — a tilted upper panel carrying two short capsule counters and a perspective floor plane carrying one long capsule counter — separated and joined by black negative space, all wrapped in a thin offset keyline that kinks inward at the waist where the two bowls of the B meet. Measured from the master artwork: the mark sits in an ~8:9 frame (0.89 width-to-height), covers ~20% of its canvas in ink, and its edges obey two dominant angle families — a fold axis at $\approx 42^\circ$ and a counter-fold at $\approx 147^\circ$ (-33°) — plus true verticals. Corners are generously rounded on the planes while the overall silhouette stays angular; that contradiction is the personality of the asset.

Verdict: retain without modification. The mark passes every functional test asked of it — it reverses cleanly, survives 16 px, reads as an object rather than a letterform, and it is distinctive enough to own. One technical requirement is recorded: the master artwork must be produced as a clean two-tone SVG (or high-bitmap PNG set) with true transparency, because the current circulated file is flattened on black. This is an export task, not a redesign; until the vector master exists, the PNG set shipped in the asset kit (Roadmap P0) is canonical.

FIG. 02 — THE MARK

PRIMARY SYMBOL — DO NOT MODIFY GEOMETRY



Positive and reversed presentations of the same master. The black canvas is part of the mark's presentation heritage, not a mandatory enclosure — the symbol may sit directly on either paper or ink.

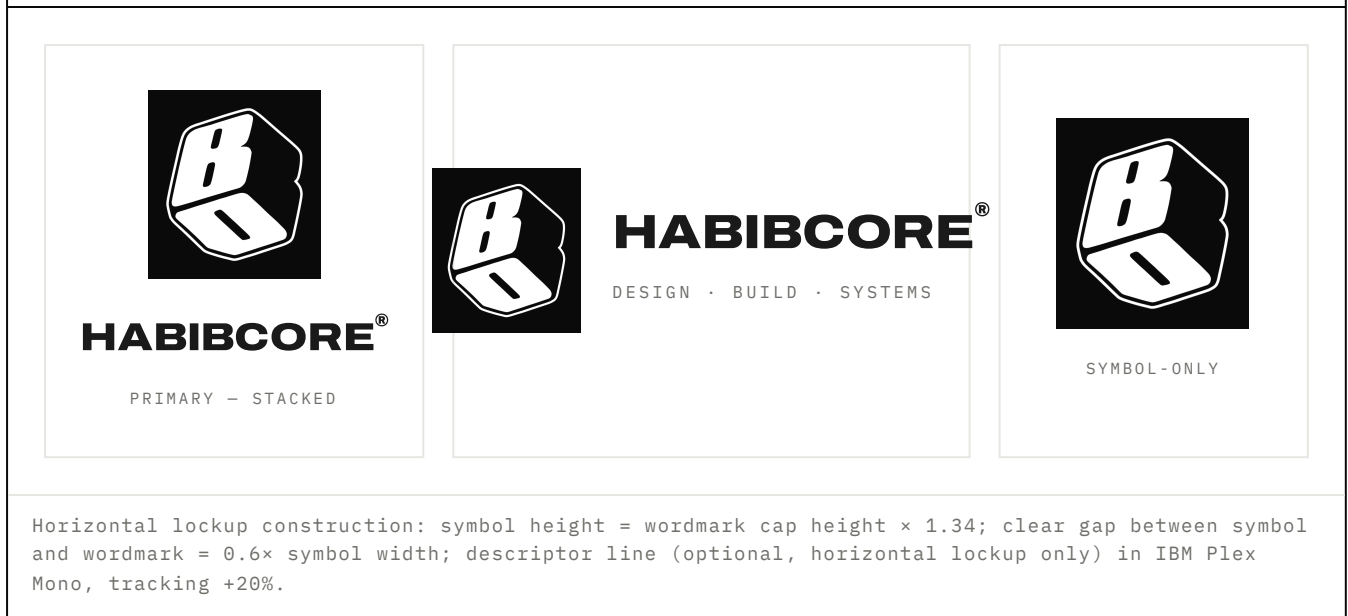
02.2 — WORDMARK

The wordmark is **HABIBCORE** set in Archivo Expanded (width 120, weight 850), uppercase, letter-spacing –1%, with the ® at cap-height scale 34%. It is typeset, not drawn: the wordmark borrows its authority from the same type system used everywhere else (Part 05), which keeps production honest — no custom lettering to maintain, perfect consistency from favicon to signage. The legal form used on the site, **HABIBCORE®**, is the standard lock; the short conversational form **Habib.** (Archivo, weight 750, sentence case, full stop included) is sanctioned for navigation, signatures and social handles where familiarity matters more than formality.

DECISION RECORD — WORDMARK		GATE: ESSENTIAL
DECISION	Typeset wordmark in Archivo Expanded 850 uppercase; retain HABIBCORE® as legal form and “Habib.” as short form. No custom logotype.	
RATIONALE	The symbol carries the distinctiveness; a custom letterform would add maintenance cost and compete with the mark. A typeset wordmark in the brand's own display style unifies identity and editorial voice at zero licence cost.	
IMPLEMENTATION	Wordmark rendered from live text wherever possible (web, docs); outlined-to-paths only for print vendors and signage. Tracking –1% at display sizes, 0 below 24 px.	
EXAMPLE	Primary lockup, FIG. 03; site masthead “HABIBCORE®”.	
RISKS	Typeset wordmarks drift when people re-set them casually. Mitigation: publish the exact settings (FIG. 03 caption) and ship a locked SVG in the asset kit.	

02.3 — LOCKUPS

Three lockups, no more. **Primary (stacked):** symbol above wordmark, centred — covers, avatars, endframes. **Horizontal:** symbol at wordmark cap-height, gap = 0.6× symbol width — headers, documents, signage. **Symbol-only:** wherever the mark has appeared before at ≥64 px or in a square container — favicons, avatars, stamps, motion. The wordmark never appears without either the symbol or a HABIBCORE context already established; the symbol never appears cropped, outlined, or enclosed in invented containers (badges, circles, shields).



02.4 — COLOUR & REVERSE BEHAVIOUR

The mark is constitutionally two-tone. Sanctioned presentations: **white on ink** (default, digital-native), **ink on paper** (print, light interfaces), **paper on Signal** (only where Signal is already the surface for a state reason — see Part 06), and **50% grey on paper** for de-emphasised contexts such as watermarks and legal pages. Anything else — gradients, outlines, coloured fills, shadows — is a violation (X.01–X.06). The mark never sits on photography; it sits on keylined plates above photography.



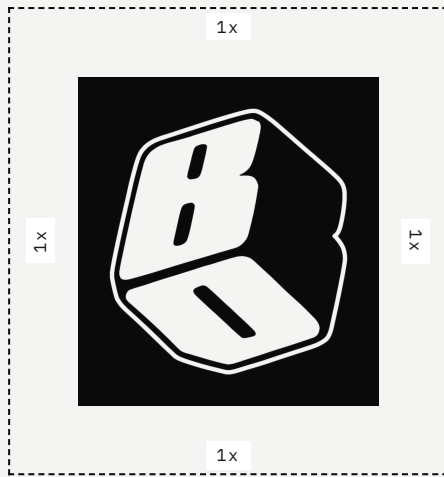
02.5 — CLEAR SPACE & MINIMUM SIZE

Clear space is defined by the mark's own anatomy, not an arbitrary margin: the exclusion zone is **1x** on all sides, where **x = the height of one capsule counter** (8% of mark height). No type, image edge, rule or fold enters that zone. The only elements permitted inside it are the wordmark in a sanctioned lockup and keyline frames that belong to the layout system (Part 04) at full-bleed distances.

Minimum sizes: symbol-only **16 px** (digital) or **5 mm** (print) — at this size the mark reads as a structural glyph and the counters remain visible; full lockups bottom out at **24 px / 8 mm** wordmark cap height. Below the floor, use the symbol at 16 px or nothing — a shrunk lockup is worse than no lockup.

FIG. 04 — CLEAR SPACE

EXCLUSION ZONE = 1X (CAPSULE HEIGHT) ALL SIDES



x is measured live from the artwork: the height of the short capsule counter in the upper plane. On the 1,208 px master this equals ≈30 px, so the exclusion zone scales with every reproduction.

Dashed boundary shown for specification only — never rendered in application.

FIG. 05 — MINIMUM SIZE

SYMBOL SURVIVES 16 PX — TESTED



96 PX



64 PX



48 PX



32 PX



24 PX



16 PX — FLOOR

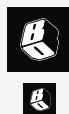
Favicon spec: 16/32 px PNG from the white-transparent master on #0A0A0A, 12% internal padding; touch icon 180 px. Below 16 px the counters fuse — never force the mark smaller; switch to a plain "H." monogram in Archivo 850.

02.6 — DIGITAL APPLICATIONS & ASSET KIT

Digital surfaces get exact recipes so the mark never suffers improvised cropping. The favicon pair is generated from the white-transparent master at 16/32 px on ink with 12% internal padding; the touch icon at 180 px; the social avatar is the symbol at 58% of a 1:1 ink canvas (the circular crop of most platforms is anticipated, not feared — the mark's keyline keeps it legible off-centre). Open Graph images use the horizontal lockup on ink at 1200 × 630. The asset kit ships as a single versioned folder: vector masters, PNG set, wordmark lockups, favicon exports, tokens.css and this manual's FIG. 03–06 as built proofs.

FIG. 06 — DIGITAL APPLICATIONS

FAVICON · TOUCH · AVATAR — BUILT FROM MASTER



FAVICON 32/16



TOUCH 180



AVATAR 58%



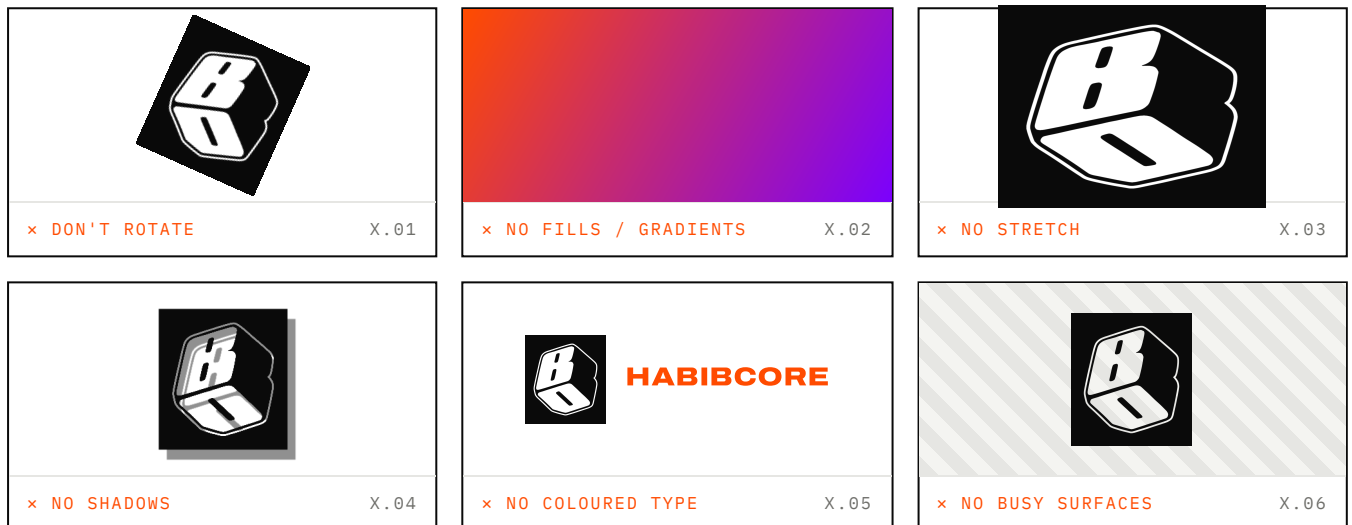
OG 1200×630

Every digital tile derives from one master — no redrawn variants. The avatar's 58% scale keeps the keyline inside platform crops; the OG plate pairs symbol + wordmark because it must work when previewed small.

ASSET KIT V1 CONTENTS	FORMAT
MARK — MASTER	SVG (two-tone vector, waist notch intact) + PNG @1x/2x/4x, both polarities, transparent
WORDMARK + LOCKUPS	SVG outlined (print) + live-text spec (web); stacked, horizontal, symbol-only
DIGITAL EXPORTS	favicon 16/32 .ico+png, touch 180, avatar 400/1000, OG 1200×630
TOKENS	tokens.css — colour, type, spacing, angle, motion variables
GOVERNANCE	This manual (PDF + HTML), decision ledger, changelog

02.7 — INCORRECT USAGE

Each prohibition exists because someone eventually tries it. The tiles below are the permanent wall of shame; asset kits ship with this figure so corrections can be pointed to, not argued.



Also banned: adding containers (circles, badges, shields) around the mark; re-spacing the lockups; substituting other typefaces in the wordmark; applying textures; animating the mark outside the motion spec in Part 09. When in doubt: the mark appears exactly as master files provide, at sanctioned sizes, on ink or paper.

PART 03 / 17

FOUNDATION → EXPRESSION

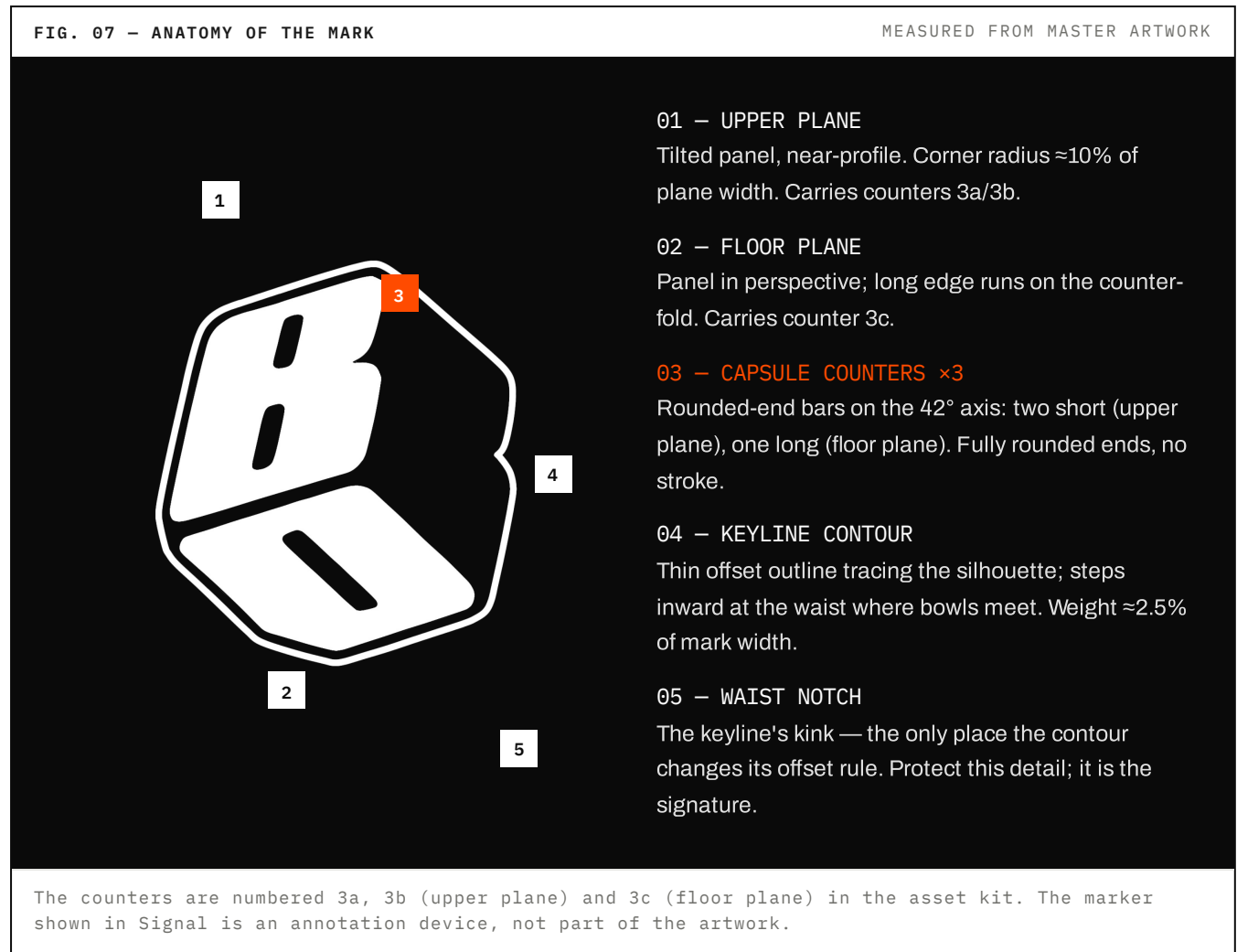
VISUAL DNA

The mark is not just a logo — it is the generator of the whole visual language. This part extracts its geometry into reusable primitives.

03.1 — ANATOMY

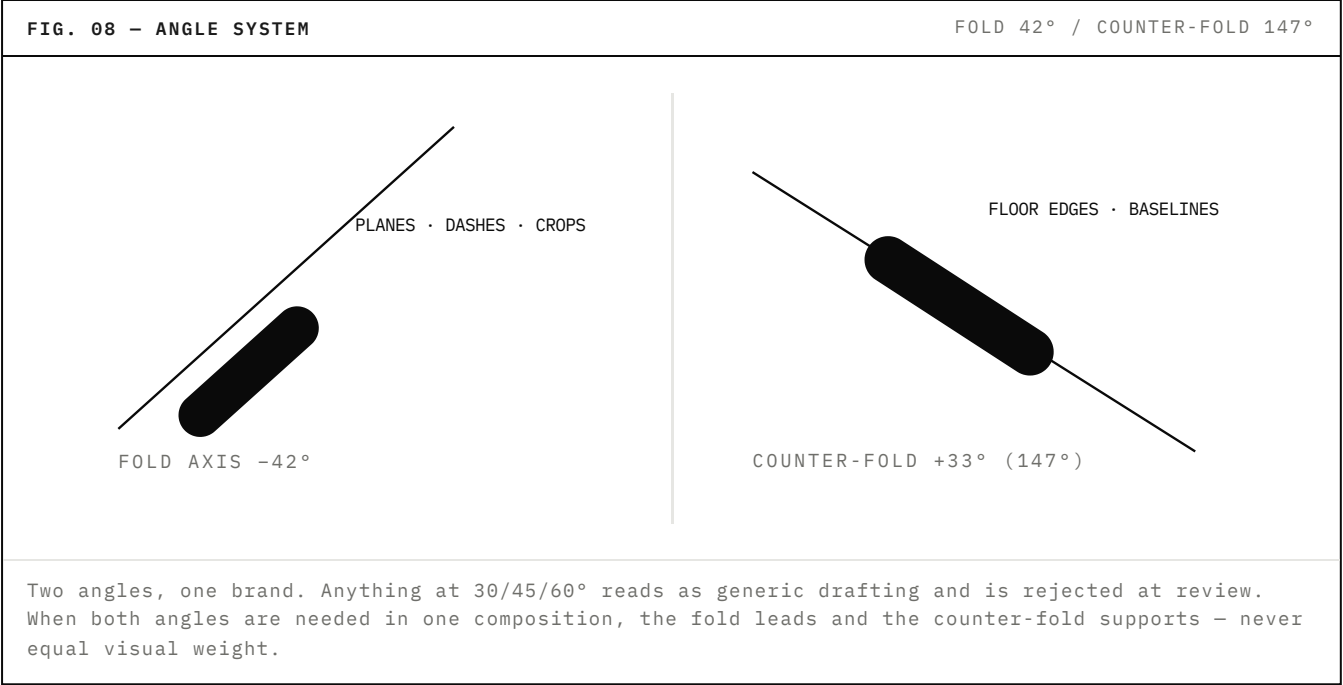
Read as construction rather than letterform, the mark is four components and two angles. The **upper plane** is a tilted rounded panel standing in near-profile. The **floor plane** is a second rounded panel laid down in perspective, carrying a single long capsule. Between and behind them, the black negative space completes the B's stem and bowls — the figure only works because the ground is allowed to do drawing work. Three

contour: a thin offset outline that traces the whole composition and kinks at the waist, like a technical drawing's border or a die-cut sticker's bleed line.



03.2 — THE ANGLE SYSTEM

Gradient-orientation analysis of the master returns two dominant families: edges running $\approx 42^\circ$ (the fold axis — both the planes' shared tilt and every capsule counter) and $\approx 147^\circ$ — equivalently -33° — the counter-fold along which the floor plane's long edge runs; true verticals do the rest. Horizontals appear only in the keyline's top and base. The system is deliberately not isometric-standard (30°): the off-angle is what makes the mark feel authored. This pair of angles becomes a tool for the entire graphic language: any diagonal introduced anywhere in the brand — crops, dividers, motion paths, image masks — must be 42° or 147° . No other diagonals exist in this system.



03.3 — EXTRACTED PRIMITIVES

Five primitives, extracted once and reused everywhere. They are the complete vocabulary — compositions that cannot be built from these five do not belong to this brand.



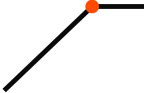
PLANEP-01



CAPSULE DASHP-02



KEYLINEP-03



FOLD JOINTP-04



42° FIELDP-05

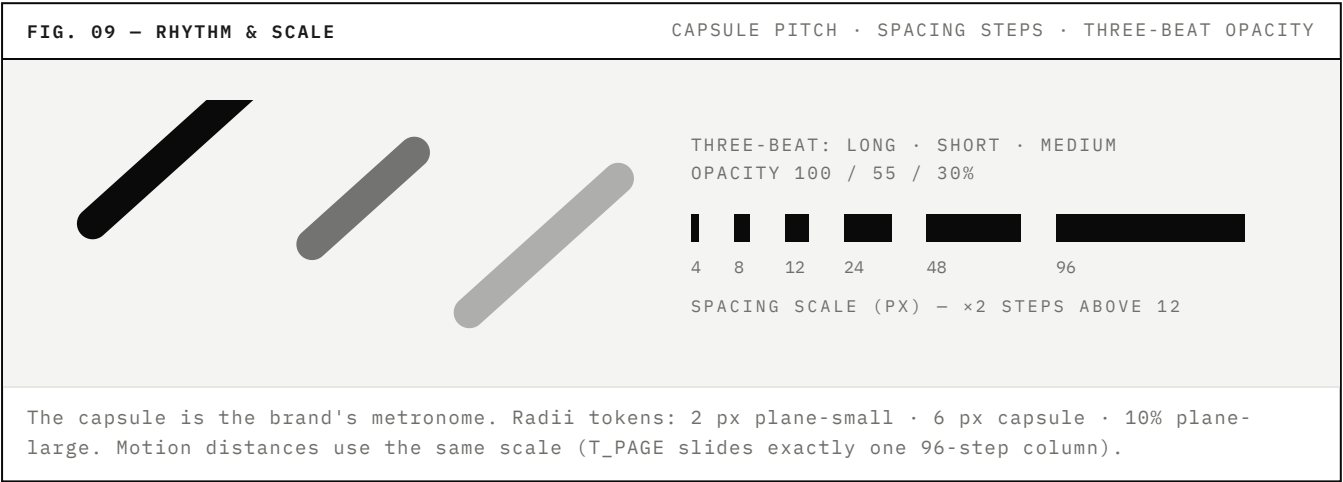
5 PRIMITIVES
∞ COMPOSITIONS
0 ORNAMENTS

RULE

TOKEN	DEFINITION	PRIMARY USE
PLANE	Rounded quad panel; corners 8–12% of width; may tilt on fold axis; may carry content	Cards, images, panels, buttons at rest
DASH	Capsule bar, height 5–6 px @1440, end radius = ½ height, always on 42° or 0° (lists only)	Bullets, dividers, loading, progress, motion feedback
KEYLINE	1–1.5 px offset contour or frame; 0.5 px hairline variant for internal structure	Frames, specimen plates, diagram borders
FOLD JOINT	The seam where two planes change angle; marked by a joint dot or weight change	Section transitions, motion choreography marks
42° FIELD	Skewed planar shape cut at -42°, used as flat fill (never gradient)	Posters, covers, hover states, emphasis blocks

03.4 — RHYTHM & PROPORTION

The mark repeats one proportion three times — the capsule — and that repetition is its rhythm. The system inherits it: spacing, radii and motion distances all step in multiples of the capsule unit. Practically this yields a **spacing scale of 4 · 8 · 12 · 24 · 48 · 96** (each step ×2 above 12), corner radii of **2 px (plane-small)** and **6 px (capsule)**, and a rule that any repeated element (list rows, cards, table stripes) keeps constant pitch — rhythm is felt when repetition is even, and broken only at section folds. The dash trio's internal logic (long · short · medium, opacity 100/55/30%) is reused verbatim wherever a three-beat pattern appears: dividers, loading bars, transition strokes, even the belt columns on the cover of this manual.



PART 04 / 17

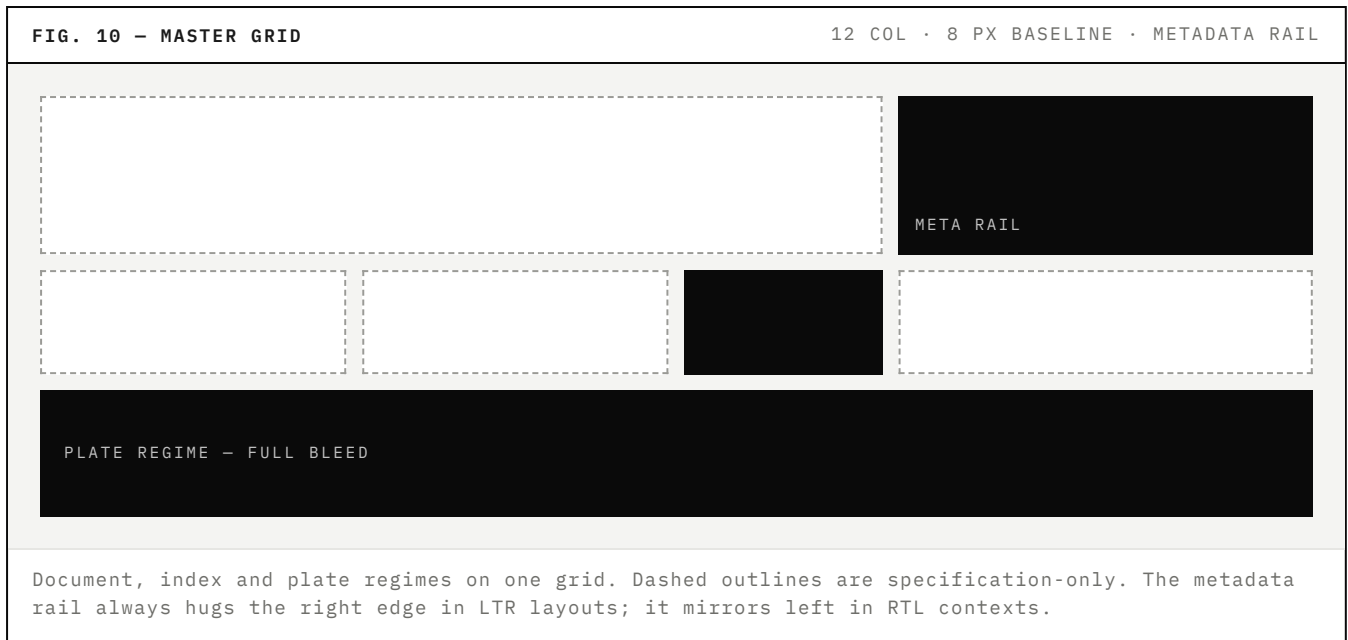
EXPRESSION

GRAPHIC SYSTEM

Grids, frames, dividers, patterns and compositions — the five DNA primitives turned into a working layout toolkit for pages, screens and print.

04.1 — GRID

The master grid is a **12-column field on an 8 px baseline**, margins equal to 6% of the short edge, gutter 16 px (web) / 4 mm (print). Columns may merge into three content regimes: **document** (single 8-column text measure, ~68 characters), **index** (2–3 column card fields), and **plate** (full-bleed image or black panel regimes). A vertical metadata rail — the rightmost column minus 40 px — carries mono metadata: coordinates, timestamps, section indices. The rail is what makes layouts feel instrumented rather than decorated.



04.2 — FRAMES, DIVIDERS & CONTAINERS

Containers descend from the keyline primitive. Three sanctioned frames: the **plate** (1.5 px keyline around an image or panel with 0 offset — the drawing-border look), the **field** (flat #F4F4F2 panel, no border, for secondary content), and the **ink block** (solid black panel for emphasis or transitions). Dividers come in two forms: the **hairline** (0.5–1 px, structural) and the **dash rule** (three capsules, echo of the counters — used where a section changes register, at most once per screen). The dash rule is a voice marker, not filler; if every section shouts, none is heard.

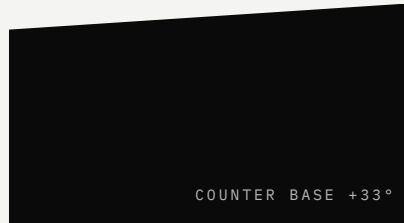


04.3 — CROPPING & COMPOSITION

Images and blocks may be cut by the fold: a **42° crop** applied as a flat diagonal removing one corner of a plate, or a **counter-fold base** where an image's lower edge runs at +33°. Crops are structural, never decorative — they direct reading order (fold removes the “past”, exposing what comes next) and they echo the mark without repeating it. Compositions favour one dominant plane plus negative space; two competing diagonals in one view is a collision, not a system. Diagonal crops appear at most once per screen or spread.



Corner removed on the fold axis;
text wraps the residual space.



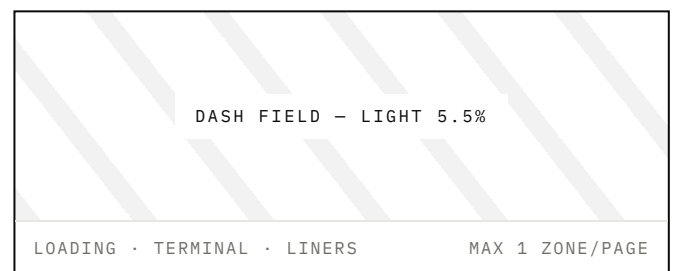
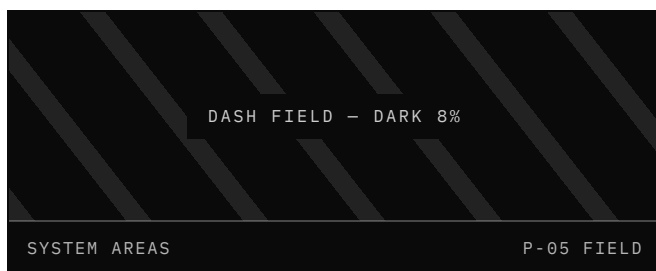
Lower edge on the counter-fold;
caption rides the slope.



Plane composition: one dominant
cut plane, one keyline window,
silence elsewhere.

04.4 — PATTERN LANGUAGE

One background pattern is sanctioned: the **dash field** — capsules at 42°, spaced at 4x, in 4–6% ink on paper or 6–8% paper on ink. It marks “system area”: loading states, error pages, terminal panels, packaging liners. The pattern never sits behind body text and never appears in more than one region of a page. A second, quieter texture is the **grid tick** — hairline crosses at 8 px baseline intersections inside technical diagrams only.

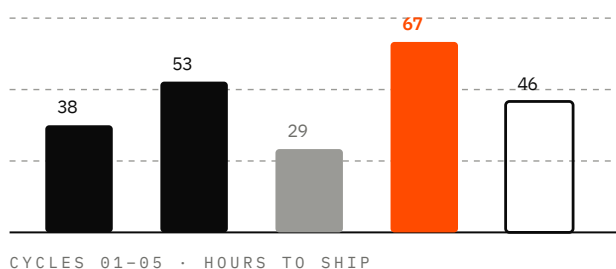


04.5 — DATA VISUALISATION LANGUAGE

Charts behave like instruments: monochrome series differentiated by fill and pattern — solid ink, 45% grey, 12% grey, outline-only — with **Signal reserved for the one series that carries the decision**. Axes hairline; grids dashed 4-3 at 8 px intervals; labels in IBM Plex Mono; values labelled directly instead of legend-hunted. Bars carry 2 px top rounding (the plane radius), never 3-D, never gradients. If a chart needs more than four series, the chart is wrong — split it.

FIG. 12 — DATA-VIZ SPECIMEN

SIGNAL MARKS THE DECISION SERIES ONLY



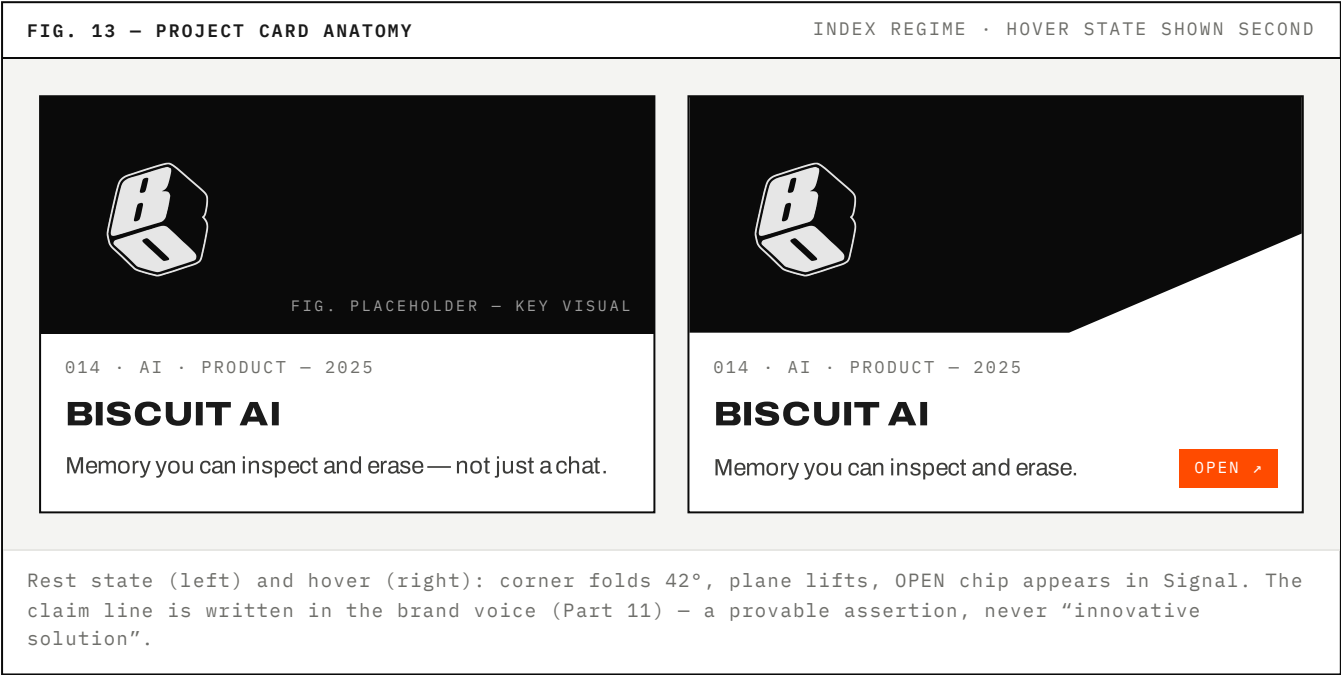
Series grammar: **solid ink** = actuals; **45% grey** = comparative; **outline** = projection;
Signal = the cycle the reader must act on.

Zero baseline always drawn; top and right spines always deleted; grid dashed 15% ink; direct value labels in mono; no legends under four series.

Same grammar scales from proposal charts to product dashboards — one instrument look everywhere.

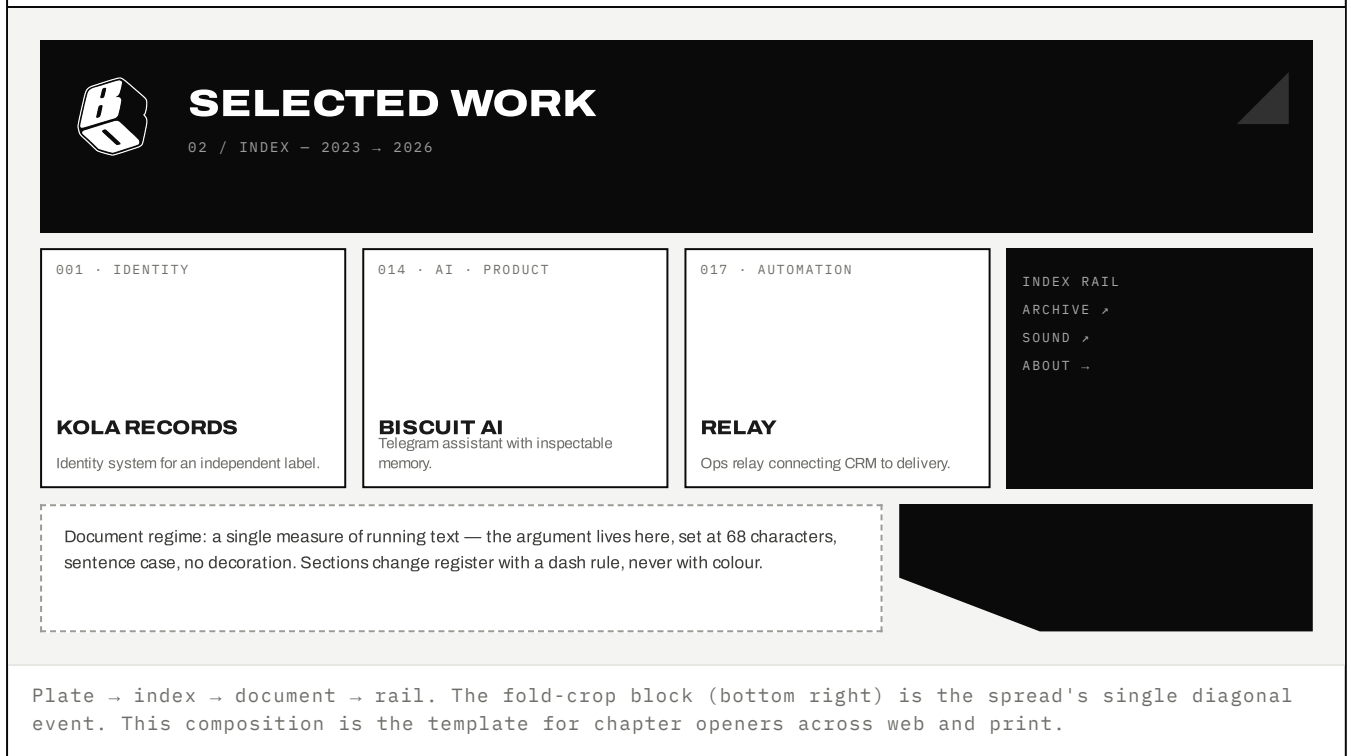
04.6 — PROJECT-CARD & SECTION-TRANSITION LANGUAGE

The project card is the portfolio's atom. Anatomy: a plate holding the key image; a mono metadata line (index, discipline tags, year); a title in Archivo Expanded; a one-line claim in sentence case; and a fold-crop on hover (the plane lifts 2 px and its corner cuts 42°, revealing a Signal-linked “OPEN ↗” chip). Cards never carry shadows; hierarchy comes from the keyline and the metadata, not elevation. **Section transitions** use the fold joint: a hairline with a single joint dot, or a black plate that slides one column-width — the page visibly “folds” to the next register (motion spec, Part 09).



04.7 — EDITORIAL COMPOSITION

Assembled, a page reads like an instrument panel: a full-bleed ink plate opens the register, the index regime lays out the evidence, one document-regime measure carries the argument, and the metadata rail stitches coordinates through all of it. The miniature spread below is the reference composition for chapter openers, case-study covers and proposal openers — adapt proportions, never the logic. Note the discipline: one diagonal event per spread (the fold crop), one Signal element at most, and every block aligned to the 12-column grid.



PART 05 / 17

EXPRESSION

TYPOGRAPHY

Two open-source families, three voices: a structural grotesque that folds between widths, and a mono that does the instrument work.

05.1 — PRIMARY TYPEFACE: ARCHIVO

Archivo (Omnibus-Type, SIL Open Font Licence) is the identity face: a grotesque with real display cuts and — decisive for this system — a **variable width axis from 62 to 125** plus weight 100–900. One family therefore behaves like a folded structure: the same skeleton compresses for dense interfaces and expands for signage, exactly the way the mark's planes fold without changing shape. Expanded caps (width ≥ 116 , weight ≥ 800) carry display duty and set the wordmark; normal width handles subheads and body; condensed (width ≤ 80) is reserved for data-dense UI tables where horizontal space is scarce. Archivo's slightly squared shoulders and even colour give it an engineered, unemotional authority — it reads as specified, not styled.

DECISION	Archivo variable is the only sans in the system, used across display, text and UI roles via width/weight axes.
RATIONALE	Zero licence cost with professional display quality; the width axis mirrors the fold concept (one structure, many angles); a single family keeps documents, site and product visually identical; strong tabular figures avoid a third family in data contexts.
IMPLEMENTATION	Self-host the variable WOFF2; define tokens --w-display:120/850, --w-sub:108/750, --w-text:100/400, --w-cond:76/500. Fallback stack: Archivo, Liberation Sans, sans-serif.
EXAMPLE	This document is set in Archivo throughout — headlines at 114–120% width, body at 100%.
RISKS	Width axis invites gimmickry (mixed-width lines). Mitigation: one width per text block; mixing widths inside a paragraph is a violation. Archivo's growing popularity is accepted — the fold behaviour plus mono pairing keeps the combination ownable.

05.2 — SECONDARY TYPEFACE: IBM PLEX MONO

IBM Plex Mono (IBM, OFL) is the instrument voice: coordinates, indices, metadata, labels, captions, code, table headers, legal lines. Mono is load-bearing in this brand — the site's instrument panel (clocks, coordinates, indices) established it, and the mark's dashes read as terminal glyphs. Plex Mono wins the seat over quirkier monos because it is genuinely engineered (true italics, tabular numerals, excellent hinting at small sizes) while staying warm enough to feel human. **Space Grotesk, JetBrains Mono and monospace “hacker” faces with curly details are rejected:** the first two are AI-startup clichés, the third fights the system's calm.

FIG. 15 — TYPE SPECIMEN

ARCHIVO WIDTH FOLD + PLEX MONO ROLES

DRAWN. CODED. SHIPPED.

EXPANDED 120 **SEMI 106** **CONDENSED 76**

Body text at normal width carries the arguments. Archivo at text sizes stays even and quiet — long measures hold without glare, and bold rows inside a paragraph keep their weight without smearing. The face should never be noticed; only remembered.

6°27'N, 3°24'E — LAGOS
SECTION 04 / SYSTEMS
STATUS — SHIPPING
TABULAR: 0123456789

The width fold, demonstrated on one skeleton. Display sits at 120–122%; never mix widths within a line.

05.3 — HIERARCHY & ROLES

ROLE	SETTING	USAGE
DISPLAY XL	Archivo 120/850 · 44–80 px · caps · –1%	Covers, hero, section plates — one per view
DISPLAY	Archivo 114/820 · 24–36 px · caps	Section titles, card titles
SUBHEAD	Archivo 106/750 · 16–19 px · caps	H3-level, labels above tables
BODY	Archivo 100/400–500 · 14–16 px · sentence case · LH 1.6	Arguments, case-study prose, UI copy
META / LABEL	Plex Mono 500 · 9–11 px · caps · tracking +12–18% · 55–70% ink	Indices, coordinates, statuses, fig captions
DATA / CODE	Plex Mono 400–600 · 11–13 px	Tables, code, terminals, chart labels
LEGAL	Plex Mono 400 · 9 px · 60% ink	Colophons, licences, footers

05.4 — TYPOGRAPHIC RULES

- 01 **Caps are structural.** Uppercase belongs to display, labels and metadata. Body text is always sentence case — caps in paragraphs read as shouting.
- 02 **One width per block.** The width axis changes register between blocks, never inside a line (the only exception: the ® symbol's optical scale).
- 03 **Metadata rides the rail.** Mono labels align to the grid's metadata rail, never floated randomly; they use middle dots and em dashes, not pipes.
- 04 **Numbers are tabular.** Any aligned column of figures uses Plex Mono tabular figures — prices, dates, indices never jitter.
- 05 **No orphan display.** A display line never sits alone at a page or section bottom; keep-with-next is mandatory (enforced in Part 10 motion specs).

PART 06 / 17

EXPRESSION

COLOUR

The question was whether an accent is needed at all. The analysis keeps the monochrome as the identity — and admits one Signal, reserved for states and nothing else.

06.1 — THE ACCENT QUESTION, ANSWERED HONESTLY

The monochrome **is** the position. In a market where “AI brand” means a purple-to-blue gradient and every portfolio competes on colour noise, surfaces of pure ink and paper read as confidence — and photograph, print and screenshot with zero drift. Colour here would cost more than it buys: it would soften the mark's

contrast DNA, multiply print variables, and push the brand toward the very aesthetics Part 15 bans.

Verdict: no decorative accent.

One exception survives the decision gates in Part 16 — **functional colour**. Digital products need unambiguous state language: live, error, attention, confirmed. Grey states are ambiguous and black-error is hostile. So the system admits a single reserved hue — **Signal**, #FF4B00 — deployed strictly as semantic equipment. It behaves like the mark's capsule counters: small, rounded, purposeful, rare. Where Signal appears, something is being said about *state*, never about *style*.

DECISION RECORD — COLOUR SYSTEM		GATE: HIGH VALUE
DECISION	Identity is achromatic: Ink #0A0A0A, Paper #FFFFFF, one grey scale. One functional accent, Signal #FF4B00, restricted to system states, annotations and decision-marking in data.	
RATIONALE	Monochrome maximises contrast DNA, print reliability and differentiation; functional colour solves a real comprehension problem (state ambiguity) that monochrome cannot solve; the discipline of scarcity turns even the accent into a brand signature.	
IMPLEMENTATION	Tokens: --ink, --paper, --g1 #F4F4F2, --g2 #E6E6E3, --g3 #6E6E6A, --signal #FF4B00 (CMYK 0/71/100/0). Signal budget: <1% of any surface; never backgrounds for text blocks; never more than one Signal element per view.	
EXAMPLE	FIG. 16 proportion bar; error/“live” states in Part 10; REJECTED markers throughout this manual.	
RISKS	Signal's authority dies the day it decorates. Mitigation: any decorative use is a P15 violation by definition; quarterly asset audits check Signal's surface share in shipped screens and documents.	

06.2 — TOKENS & BEHAVIOUR

FIG. 16 — TOKEN SET			5 VALUES + 1 RESERVED
INK · #0A0A0A Ground, text, plates, motion assembly	PAPER · #FFFFFF Documents, interfaces, the default canvas	G1 · #F4F4F2 Fields, table stripes, quiet panels	
G2 · #E6E6E3 Hairlines, dividers, disabled	G3 · #6E6E6A Metadata, captions, secondary text	SIGNAL · #FF4B00 States only — live · error · decision · annotation	
PAPER 60–70%	INK 20–30%	G	
Surface budget per view. Signal's 1–3% share is a ceiling, not a target — many legitimate pages contain zero Signal.			

06.3 — WHERE SIGNAL APPEARS — AND NEVER APPEARS

APPEARS	NEVER APPEARS
● System states: live indicators, recording dots, error highlights, destructive-action confirmation ● Annotation: the marker pen on technical diagrams and this manual's rejection stamps ● Data: exactly one decision series per chart ● Motion feedback: the hover chip, the completed checkmark, the fold joint flash on lock ● Wayfinding: “you are here” — current nav item underline, active step in flows	● Logos, wordmarks or any recolouring of the mark ● Body text, headlines or links at rest ● Backgrounds of text blocks; full-bleed surfaces (the only sanctioned full-surface use: the mark's state plate, FIG. 03 tile) ● Gradients in any direction, at any opacity ● Decoration: dividers, patterns, “energy”, or because a page feels flat

Accessibility: Signal on Paper contrast 3.6:1 — approved for graphical objects and ≥18 px bold text only; never for body-size text. Ink on Paper 19.4:1; G3 on Paper 5.2:1; Paper on Ink 19.4:1. All pairings in this manual meet WCAG AA for their roles; Signal-as-text is restricted to the annotated labels shown here.

PART 07 / 17

EXPRESSION

IMAGERY

Art direction for a practice whose best images are its own work: screens, drawings, terminals, rooms and hands — processed until they obey the monochrome discipline.

07.1 — DOCTRINE: THE WORK IS THE IMAGE

HABIBCORE does not need mood photography to feel significant; the work carries the frames. The image system therefore prioritises **evidence** over atmosphere: interface captures, technical drawings, printed matter photographed in real light, the workshop desk, Lagos architecture, transit and street geometry that already behave like the mark. People appear as **operator, not model** — hands at a keyboard, a print being checked against a proof, a whiteboard mid-system. Every image is processed through one pipeline (FIG. 17) so a photograph of a paper prototype and a screenshot of a production dashboard clearly belong to the same practice.

CATEGORY	DIRECTION
PROJECT / SCREENS	Native-resolution captures on the real surface (browser chrome allowed), framed as plates with mono metadata; never angled 3-D mockups, never invented devices
PROCESS / WORKSHOP	Sketches, grid printouts, terminal sessions, cable runs — hard light, honest mess; the subject is method, not vibes

07.4 — FOUNDING SHOT LIST

Twelve frames that restate the identity in photography — the first shoot against the wall of any rebrand indecision. Every frame obeys the pipeline (FIG. 17); every frame has a job in the layout, named here so nothing is shot “for the vibe”.

#	FRAME	DIRECTION	DEPLOYS IN
01	Operator portrait, hard light	Front-on, plain wall, mono treatment; the recognition asset	About, profiles, press
02	Hands at the keyboard, terminal live	Over-shoulder 35°, screen glow only source	Hero plate, case studies
03	Sketch wall — grid printouts + markers	Square-on, full wall, threshold treatment	Process sections
04	Print proof vs screen check	Close crop, hands + paper, honest colour mismatch visible	Case studies (craft proof)
05	Lagos facade grid	Square-on elevation, fold-axis shadow line	Editorial interludes
06	Workshop desk, top-down	Objects at 0°/90°/−42° only; cables allowed to misbehave once	Covers, about
07	Biscuit AI production screen	Native capture, real data, chrome visible	Case study 03 BUILD
08	Relay automation schema	The real diagram, redrawn in system grammar if needed	Case study 02 SYSTEM
09	Night build — monitor + tea	Single practical light; the 2 a.m. clause made visible	Voice sections, ops pages
10	Folded-paper mark study	The mark's geometry in paper, raking light	DNA sections, social
11	Transit geometry (bridge/stairs)	Shot on the fold axis; people unposed	Editorial interludes
12	Training session whiteboard	Mid-explanation, diagrams half-erased — method over polish	Training offer, about

PART 08 / 17

EXPRESSION

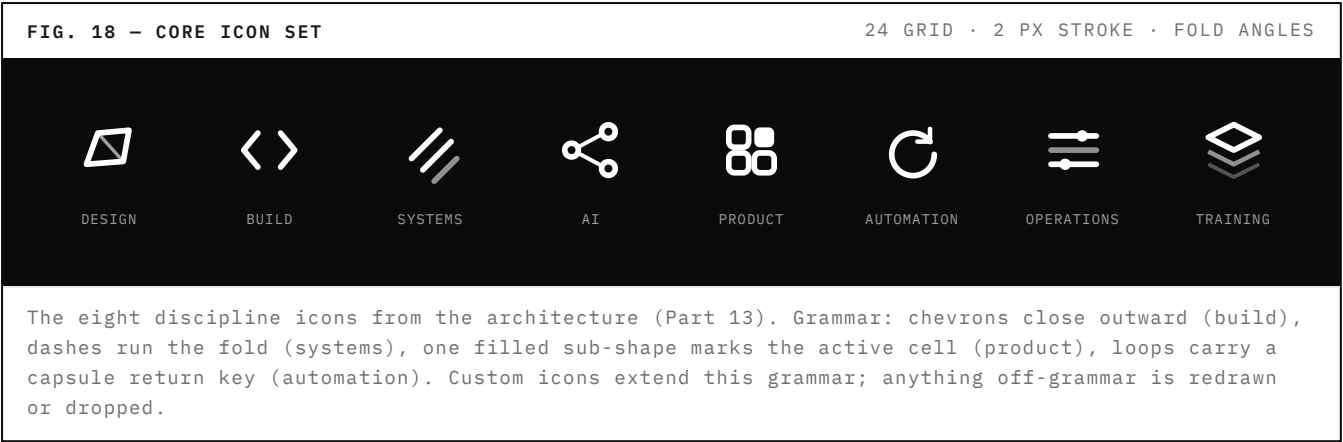
ICONOGRAPHY

Icons are the mark's smaller siblings: same grid, same angle families, same capsule logic — built for interfaces first, print second.

08.1 — CONSTRUCTION RULES

The icon grid is **24 × 24 px** with a 2 px live area inset. Strokes are **2 px (rounded caps, rounded joins)** — the capsule ends echo the counters. Diagonals are cut on **−42°** only; corners close at 2 px radius; filled shapes use the plane radius (2–3 px). Filled versus outlined: **outlined is default** (drawing, open state);

automatically. At 16 px and below, strokes bump to 2.5 px and interior detail is removed (the “16 px rule”: if it does not survive, redraw simpler — never shrink blindly).



08.2 — BEHAVIOUR & MOTION

Icons animate only along their own geometry: strokes draw on over 240 ms (ease-out, 42° paths first), filled states crossfade — no bounce, no spin, no wobble. In data tables, the filled/outline pair doubles as boolean state (done/open), reducing colour dependency — another way the system stays monochrome-functional. Icon + label lockups set the label in Plex Mono 9 px caps under the icon with 6 px gap; side-by-side lockups align icon and label baseline.

PART 09 / 17

EXPRESSION + EXPERIMENTATION

MOTION SYSTEM

Five genuinely different directions were explored before one was selected. Motion is treated as behaviour with a physics, not decoration with a timeline.

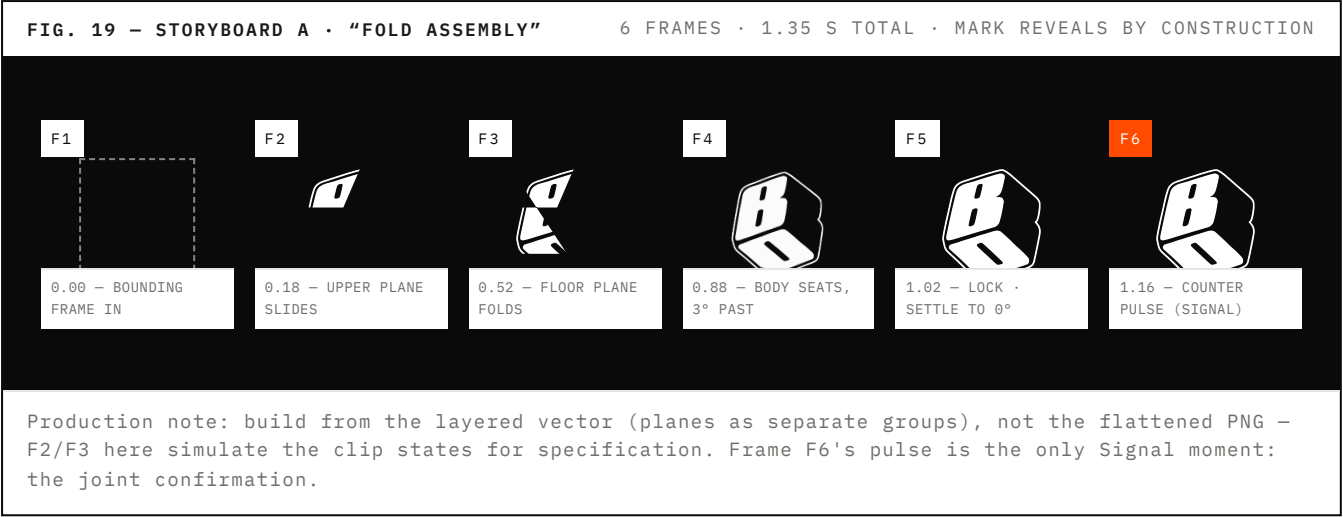
09.1 — MOTION PHYSICS (PRINCIPLES BEFORE DIRECTION)

Whatever the style, all HABIBCORE motion obeys five physical laws. **1 — Mass:** elements have weight; they accelerate and decelerate like loaded objects, never float. **2 — Fold logic:** movement follows the angle system — things travel along -42°/+33° paths or true axes; curved arcs are foreign. **3 — Lock:** motion ends in a snap — a slight overshoot (≤2%) and a settle, like a joint clicking into place. **4 — Economy:** one idea moves at a time; two simultaneous animations require a hierarchy (lead + echo at 60% distance). **5 — Silence:** motion states resolve to stillness; nothing loops permanently except state indicators (loading, live) and nothing loops at all without information. Durations live in a fixed scale, easing in three flavours — the tokens at 09.6.

09.2 — DIRECTION A — STRUCTURAL / ARCHITECTURAL

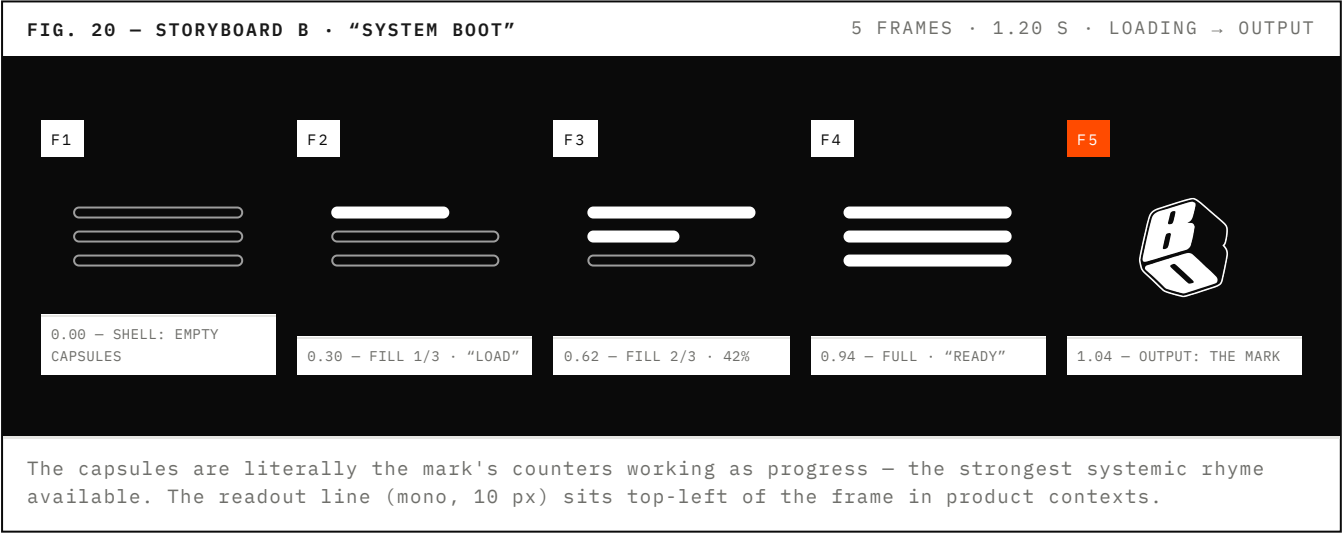
Concept: the brand behaves like construction. The mark assembles from its planes: panels slide in along the fold axis, rotate to lock at -42°, the counters pulse²³ once as the joints seat, and the keyline traces the

finished silhouette last. Sections of a page fold open like the mark — a black plate slides one column, the content plane rotates 3° and settles. The idea is *assembly you can feel*: every appearance is a small construction event with an audible logic even when silent.



09.3 — DIRECTION B — DIGITAL / SYSTEMIC

Concept: the brand behaves like a process on a machine. The mark's capsules become progress: three dashes fill left-to-right while a mono readout reports state (BOOT → LOAD → READY), coordinates tick, the bounding frame draws itself as a selection marquee, and the mark arrives as the “output” of the routine. Interfaces inherit the whole vocabulary: skeleton loaders shaped as dash fields, tab transitions that slide along the 8 px baseline, success states that print like terminal output. The idea: *the brand is a running system you happen to be watching*.



09.4 — DIRECTIONS C, D, E — EXPLORED, THEN JUDGED

C — Editorial / art-directed: the brand moves like print coming alive — images reveal through keyline wipes, headlines set themselves letter-group by letter-group at reading pace, compositions rebalance as crops shift. Restrained and elegant; risks feeling slow where the brand needs machine confidence, and it borrows no logic from the mark. **D — Spatial / dimensional:** the mark as a lit 3-D object with parallax planes and controlled camera drift. Seductive in a reel, expensive to maintain, and it pushes the identity

at baselines, caps slide on -42° , the width axis animates from condensed to expanded as a signature transition. Genuinely promising as a secondary layer, but as the lead identity it makes the system all voice and no object.

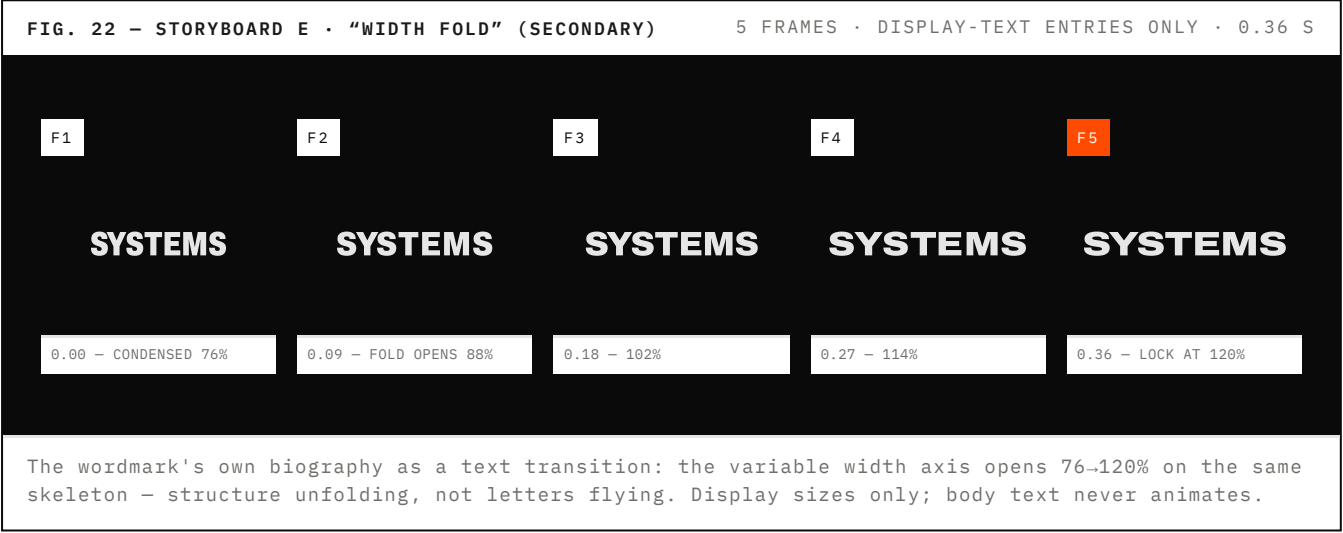
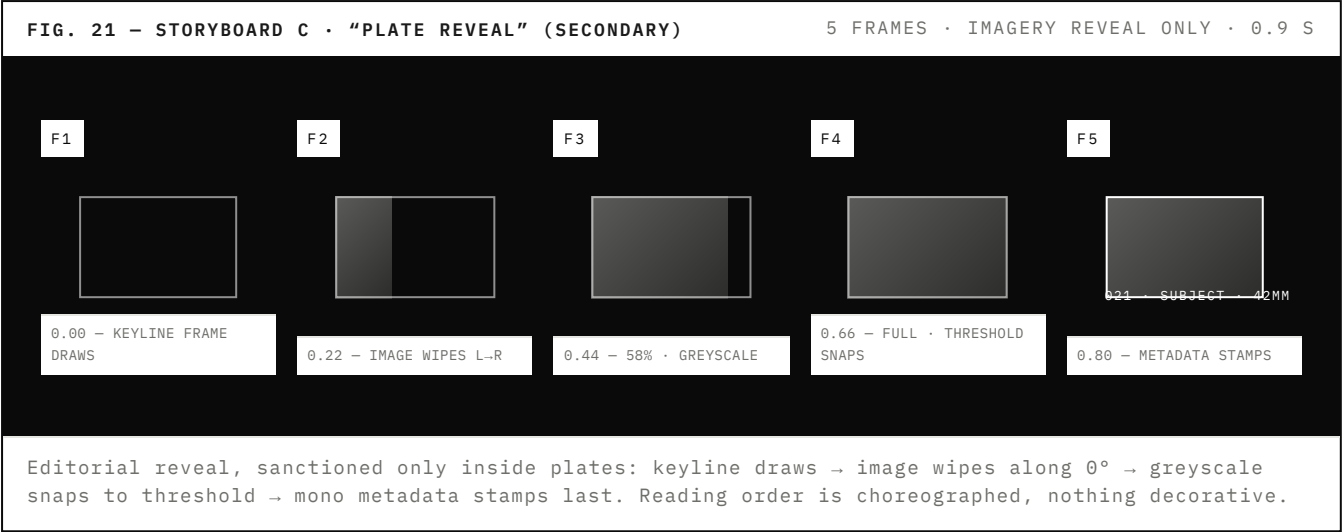


FIG. 23 – EVALUATION MATRIX

■■■■■ STRONG → □□□□ WEAK • SCORES /5

CRITERION	A • STRUCTURAL	B • SYSTEMIC	C • EDITORIAL	D • SPATIAL	E • KINETIC TYPE
Distinctiveness	■■■■■	■■■■□	■■■□□	■■■□□	■■■■□
Brand fit	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■□□	■■□□□	■■■■□
Production economy	■■■■□	■■■■■	■■■□□	■□□□□	■■■□□
Digital usefulness	■■■■□	■■■■■	■■□□□	■□□□□	■■■■□
Long-term viability	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■■□	■■□□□	■■■■□
Gimmick resistance	■■■■□	■■■■■	■■■■□	■□□□□	■■■□□
Verdict	SELECTED — signature	SELECTED — functional layer	Secondary, imagery only	REJECTED	Secondary, transitions only
Direction A wins the identity role – it is the only style whose physics are literally the mark's biography. B wins the product layer – its capsules, readouts and boot states are the most natively digital. C survives as the imagery-reveal style (Part 07), E as the width-fold text transition (09.6). D is rejected outright: highest cost, weakest fit, highest slop risk.					

DECISION	Structural assembly (A) is the brand's motion signature; systemic states (B) is the functional motion layer; editorial reveals (C) govern imagery; kinetic width-fold (E) is the single sanctioned text transition. Spatial rendering (D) is rejected.
RATIONALE	A and B are derived from the mark's own anatomy (planes, joints, capsules) — they scale from favicon-load to case-study film without changing logic, and they survive novelty decay because they describe how the practice actually works (build → lock → run).
IMPLEMENTATION	Ship one 1.35 s logo assembly (FIG. 19) for endframes/avatars; adopt B's dash loaders sitewide; encode tokens (09.6) in CSS variables; forbid D-class effects in code review via the banned-property list (15.3).
EXAMPLE	Site load: boot dashes → mark assembly → nav settles — total under 1.6 s to interactive.
RISKS	Assembly choreography becomes tiresome if repeated at full length. Mitigation: full assembly plays once per session; subsequent appearances use the 320 ms lock-settle shorthand.

09.5 — MOTION TOKENS

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
T_MICRO	120 ms · ease-out	Hover lifts, focus rings, chip reveals
T_UI	240 ms · cubic(.2,.7,.2,1)	Menus, tabs, accordions, card fold
T_LOCK	320 ms · overshoot 1.02 → settle	The signature settle; elements arriving at rest
T_ASSEMBLE	1350 ms · staged (F1–F6)	Logo build; once per session, then T_LOCK shorthand
T_PAGE	420 ms · plate slide 1 column	Section transitions, route changes
T_TEXTFOLD	360 ms · width 76 → 120%	The E-transition: display lines unfold on entry
T_SPLINE	–42° paths only	All travel is linear on system angles or true axes

09.6 — MOTION PROHIBITIONS

- **No idle rotation** of the mark — a stationary object that is assembled has no reason to spin; spinning reads as placeholder energy.
- **No parallax on content** — parallax is reserved for... nothing, currently. Re-evaluate only via the Part 16 gates.
- **No entrance choreography for text below display size** — body copy arrives with the page, fully set.
- **No motion without state meaning:** if a designer cannot name the state an animation communicates (loading/locked/live), it is deleted.
- **Reduced-motion contract:** every choreographed sequence has a named reduced-motion equivalent (assembly → single fade-in at T_LOCK; dashes → static 42% fill). The brand never depends on movement to be understood.

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

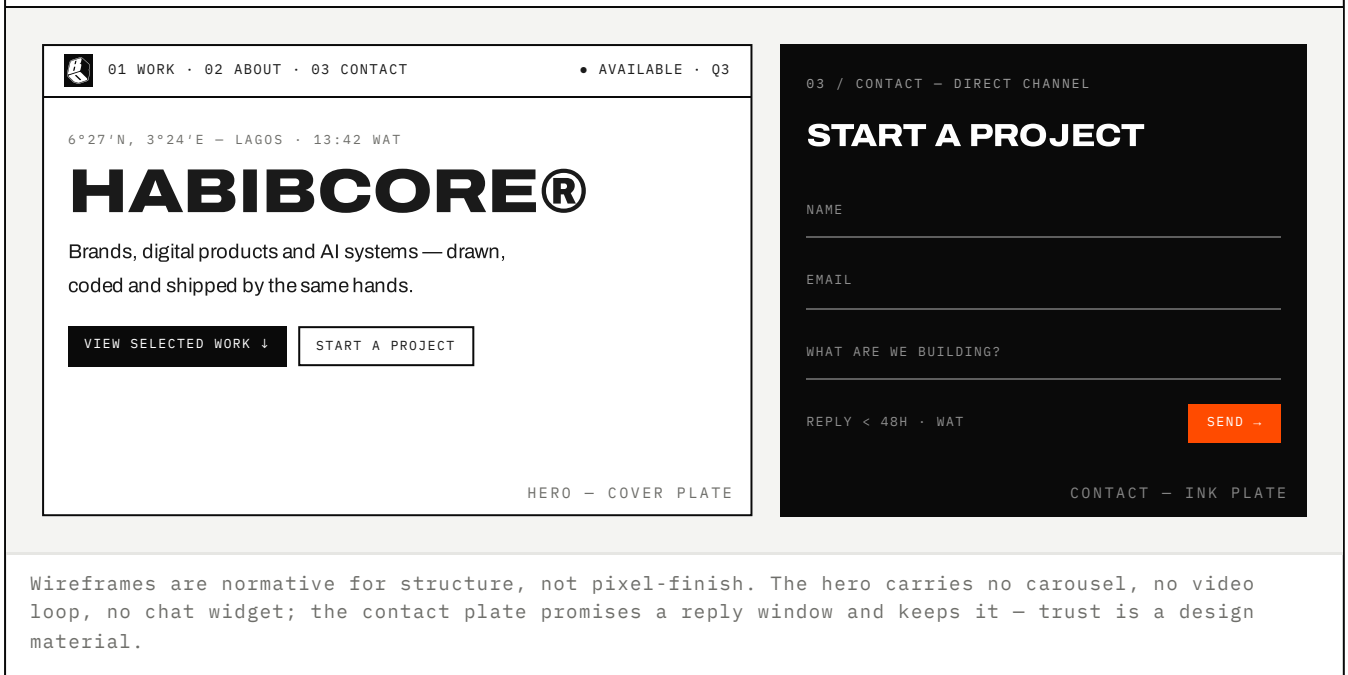
The portfolio is the brand operating as a product. Audit first: what habibcore.com already does right, then the interaction specification for everything a visitor touches.

10.1 — AUDIT: WHAT THE CURRENT SITE ALREADY GETS RIGHT

The live site (audited 2026) already behaves like the brand system in embryo — this document confirms and codifies rather than replaces. **Retain:** the numbered-section architecture (00 COVER → 08 CONTACT) which makes the site read like an engineered document; the instrument layer (live WAT clock, Lagos coordinates, availability status); the first-person proof voice (“I design it. I build it. I answer for it.”); the discipline belt (eight fixed disciplines, diamond-separated); the bold play layer (HABIBCORE® SOUND) that proves personality without decoration; and dark-surface defaults with mono metadata. **Tighten:** enforce the angle system on any diagonal elements; adopt the dash-loader and fold-transition behaviours; unify the 404 page with the master system (it currently drifts); give project cards the FIG. 13 anatomy with case-study depth per Part 10.4.

10.2 — NAVIGATION & HERO

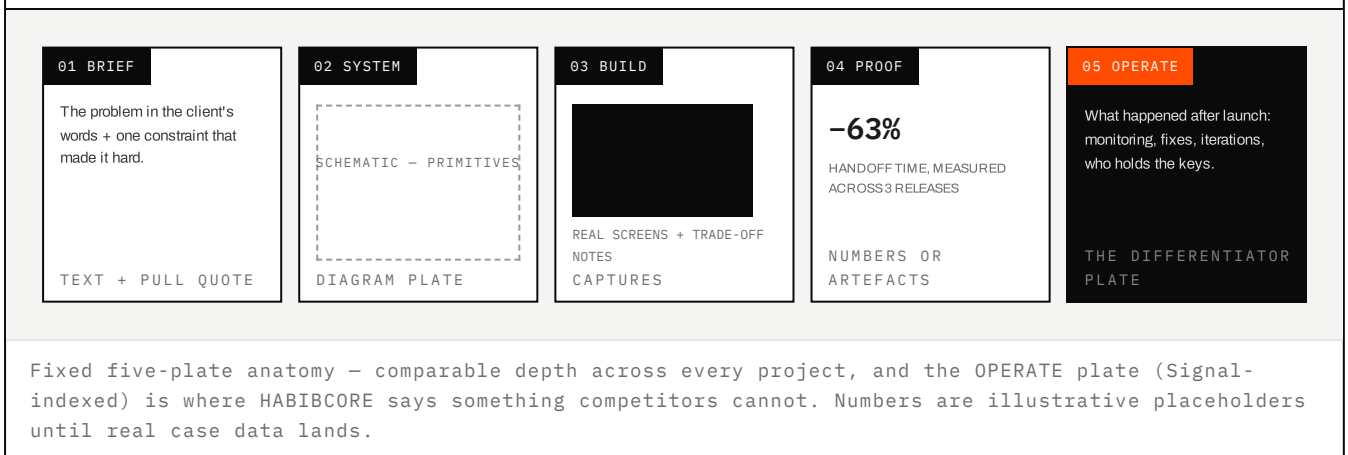
Navigation is a header instrument rail: symbol at 24 px left; section index (01 WORK · 02 ABOUT · 03 CONTACT) in Plex Mono; right-aligned status capsule — “AVAILABLE · Q3” with a live dot (Signal when accepting work, G3 when booked). On scroll the rail collapses to a 48 px bar with a hairline; the index never hides behind a hamburger on desktop. **Mobile** keeps the same rail with the index in a full-screen ink plate that folds down (T_PAGE) — not a side drawer; the fold direction matches the mark's geometry. **Hero** is a cover plate, not a slideshow: coordinates and section index in the rail, HABIBCORE® display set at viewport width – margins, the claim line beneath in body voice, and the mark assembled once (FIG. 19) on first load. The hero states the loop in eight words or fewer and offers exactly two actions: **VIEW SELECTED WORK** and **START A PROJECT**.



10.3 — PROJECT INDEX, CARDS & CASE STUDIES

The index is a dense, filterable register: rows or cards (FIG. 13) with mono metadata (index · discipline · year), fold-crop hover, and a persistent “FULL ARCHIVE ↗” rail item. Filters are the eight disciplines (Part 13) as toggle chips — outline at rest, filled when active, one row, horizontally scrollable on mobile. **Case studies** follow a fixed five-plate anatomy so depth is comparable across projects: **01 BRIEF** (the problem in the client's terms), **02 SYSTEM** (the approach as diagram — this is where the DNA primitives shine as schematic language), **03 BUILD** (real screens, real code, decisions and trade-offs in mono annotation), **04 PROOF** (outcomes with numbers; if a number cannot be shared, a verifiable artefact instead), **05 OPERATE** (what happened after launch — monitoring, iterations, handoff). The OPERATE plate is the differentiation plate: almost nobody in this market can write it.

FIG. 25 — CASE-STUDY FIVE-PLATE ANATOMY



10.4 — INTERACTION INVENTORY

CURSOR	System cursor retained for text and UI (usability first); custom cursor only as a 12 px keyline ring on plates, morphing to “OPEN ↗” tag on interactive imagery. Never hides the cursor; never delays it.
HOVER	Plates lift 2 px with corner fold (FIG. 13); links get a dash underline that fills left-to-right in T_MICRO; buttons invert ink/paper. Signal appears only as the OPEN chip or live dot.
BUTTONS	Rectangles, plane radius 2 px, mono 10 px caps, tracking +12%. Primary: ink fill. Secondary: 1.5 px keyline. Destructive: keyline + Signal label, confirmed by typed word — no red modal floods.
FORMS	Underline fields on ink plates, hairline fields on paper; labels above in mono; validation is inline mono text with a dash marker — “× EMAIL LOOKS OFF” in Signal; success prints as a terminal line: “RECEIVED · 13:42 WAT · REPLY < 48H”.
LOADING	Direction B dash loaders; skeleton surfaces use the dash field at 5.5%; images blur-up in greyscale then snap to full contrast on load (threshold arrival).
PAGE TRANSITIONS	Plate slide (T_PAGE): a black plate wipes one column across the viewport, new section settles under it; back = reverse fold. No fades-only transitions — the fold is the brand's signature move.
SCROLL	Native scrolling preserved; section indices update in the rail; scroll progress is shown as a dash filling in the footer rail — information, not ornament. No scroll-jacking, no snap hijack.
MOBILE	Single-column document regime; index rail becomes top strip; cards full-width with 1.5 px keylines; touch targets ≥44 px; the fold-crop hover becomes a press state (corner cuts on touch-down, returns on release).
ERROR / EMPTY	Errors are ink plates with mono explanations and one recovery action: “404 — NOTHING AT THIS COORDINATE. RETURN TO COVER →”. Empty states use the dash field plus a sentence in brand voice — never an illustration mascot.

PART 11 / 17

EXPRESSION

BRAND VOICE

Direct, technical, human, unpretentious. The voice is the identity spoken aloud — and it is already half-alive on the site. This part finishes the job.

11.1 — VOICE FOUNDATIONS

The voice belongs to a specific person, and it speaks in the first person — “**I**” for practice and craft (“I build”, “I answer”), “**we**” only inside a named client collaboration (“we shipped Relay together in nine weeks”). Sentences are short and declarative; technical terms are used precisely and never embarrassed (“vector master”, “RLHF fine-tune”, “idempotent webhooks” — said once, correctly, no glossary theatre). Confidence is shown as specifics: numbers, dates, stack names, outcomes. Rhythm alternates a long working sentence with a short verdict — setup, snap — mirroring the motion system's assemble-and-lock. Humour exists in one-liners with a straight face (“six years deep”), never in jokes that need explaining.

SAY	NEVER SAY
“Drawn, coded and shipped by the same hands.”	“Passionate about crafting innovative solutions.”
“Here's the trade-off, and why I chose it.”	“Best-in-class, world-class, cutting-edge.”

“This broke in production. Here's the fix and the lesson.”

“Seamless end-to-end synergy.”

“Reply within 48 hours, Lagos time.”

“Let's connect and explore synergies!”

“The system runs itself; I keep the keys.”

“Leveraging AI to revolutionise your workflow.”

11.2 — HEADLINES, MICROCOPY & CALLS TO ACTION

Headlines are claims, compressed: “Memory you can inspect and erase — not just a chat.” Pattern: assertion + anti-cliché tail, separated by an em dash or period. **Microcopy** speaks like the operator in the room: buttons are verbs with objects (“START A PROJECT”, not “Submit”), errors state the problem and the exit (“That email looks off — check the domain”), empty states explain (“No automation case studies yet — the archive lands Q4”). **CTAs** never discount, never urgency-bait (“limited slots!!” is banned); scarcity is stated as fact once: “Available for select projects — Q3.” One CTA per view wins; two maximum, and they must be different verbs.

11.3 — REWRITES: TEMPLATE VOICE → HABIBCORE VOICE

Three before/after pairs calibrate the edit. The pattern in every rewrite: agency abstraction becomes a specific claim, features become consequences, and the passive collective becomes one accountable person.

TEMPLATE VOICE (REJECTED)	HABIBCORE VOICE (SHIPPED)
“We are passionate about crafting innovative digital experiences that transform brands.”	“I redesigned the storefront and rebuilt the checkout. Conversion went up 22% in six weeks — the numbers are in the case study.”
“Our cutting-edge AI solutions leverage the latest technologies to streamline your workflow.”	“The assistant answers from your own documents, shows its sources, and lets you delete what it remembers. Built on OpenRouter, running since March.”
“Partner with us for a seamless end-to-end journey!”	“One person designs it, builds it, and answers for it. Brief me on Thursday, see the first working version the following one.”

VOICE TEST — RUN ON EVERY SENTENCE

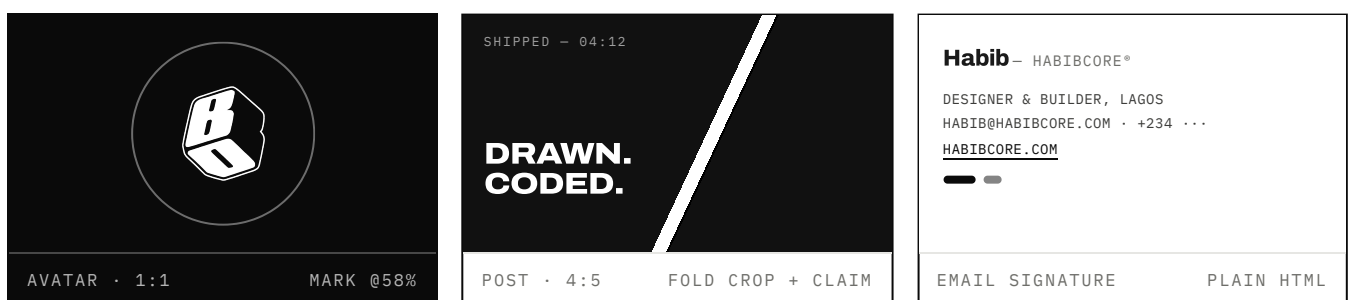
Could a stranger attribute this sentence to HABIBCORE and not to an agency template? Does it contain a fact a competitor could not copy? Would the author say it aloud at a worktable in Lagos at 2 a.m.? Three yeses ship; one no means rewrite.

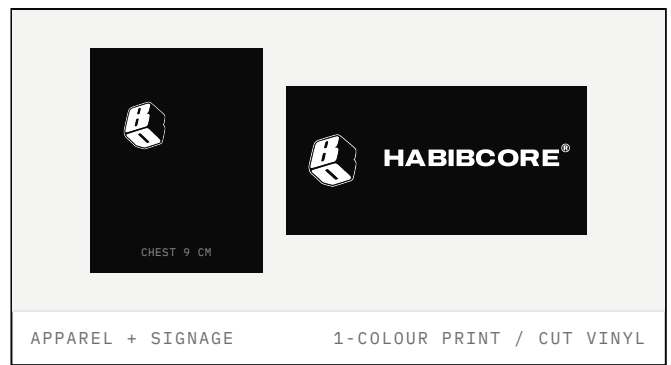
APPLICATIONS

The system applied to the artefacts an independent practitioner actually uses — prioritised by real frequency, not portfolio fantasy.

12.1 — PRIORITY APPLICATIONS

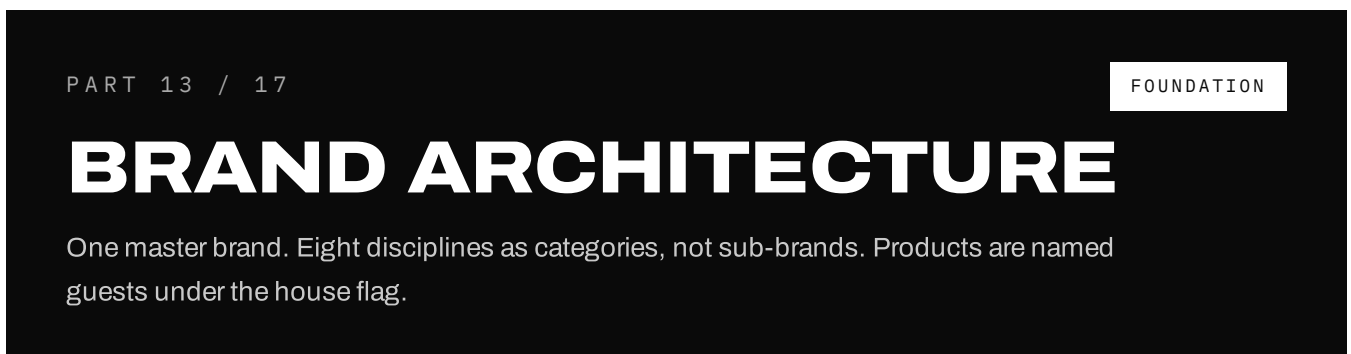
Ranked by how often they earn their keep. **Tier 1 (weekly):** website, project covers, proposals and quotes (PDF), email signature, social. **Tier 2 (per project):** case-study covers, presentations, invoices, contracts. **Tier 3 (identity moments):** business cards, apparel, packaging liners, signage. Every application obeys the same four laws: monochrome surfaces, keyline plates, mono metadata, Signal budget $\leq 1\%$. Applications never introduce new colours, new typefaces, or new shapes outside the primitive set.





12.2 — FORMAT NOTES

- **Documents (PDF):** A4, 6% margins, ink cover plate, hairline section rules, mono footers with index — this manual is the reference implementation.
- **Presentations:** 16:9 plates, one idea per plate, title bottom-left mono, black section plates between chapters; no template themes.
- **Packaging (drives, print kits, merch boxes):** kraft or matte black stock, dash-field liner, one keyline stamp; no plastic windows, no foil.
- **Merch:** apparel prints stay 1-colour; the mark never spans a seam; the SOUND track-listing gag (site easter egg) may appear inside-label only — the joke stays insider.



13.1 — THE DECISION: MASTER BRAND WITH DISCIPLINE CATEGORIES

The practice's eight areas — Brand Identity, Product Design, Software, AI Systems, Automation, Creative Direction, Graphic Design, Training — are **capabilities of one pair of hands, not business units**. Sub-brands would multiply names to maintain, split recognition eight ways, and falsify the core claim (one accountable builder). Instead the master brand carries everything, and disciplines appear as **metadata**: filters, tags and case-study categories in exactly the mono format used across the system (AI · PRODUCT — 2025). New capabilities may be added by the same mechanism without touching the architecture.

Products are the one exception. Biscuit AI and Relay are guest names — they get their own product names because users, not clients, meet them; but each carries a fixed endorsement line (“a HABIBCORE system”), the keyline plate, and a footer link to the master. Products never receive their own logos; they inherit the icon grammar (Part 08) and the type system. If a product is ever spun out with investors and its

own identity, the endorsement converts to “built by HABIBCORE” and the architecture is unaffected — the model is reversible by design (Gate 9, Part 16).

LEVEL	NAME	TREATMENT
MASTER	HABIBCORE®	Full identity — mark, wordmark, all systems
CATEGORY ×8	Brand Identity · Product Design · Software · AI Systems · Automation · Creative Direction · Graphic Design · Training	Plain-text tags in Plex Mono caps; diamond separators on the belt; filter chips in UI; never logos, never colours
PRODUCT	Biscuit AI · Relay (and future named systems)	Own name in Archivo, endorsed “a HABIBCORE system”; keyline plate + master footer; no independent logo
INITIATIVE	HABIBCORE® SOUND · archive · training cohorts	Campaign layer (EXPERIMENTATION): mono lockups only, time-boxed, collapsible

DECISION RECORD — ARCHITECTURE		GATE: ESSENTIAL
DECISION	Branded-house: one master brand, disciplines as plain-text categories, products as endorsed guests, initiatives as time-boxed campaigns.	
RATIONALE	Concentrates recognition on the only scarce asset (the name + mark), keeps the one-pair-of-hands story literal, and scales by appending metadata instead of minting identities. Endorsement model preserves optionality for product spin-outs.	
IMPLEMENTATION	Lock the eight-category string (site belt already carries it); add endorsement line to product UIs; bar sub-brand naming in proposals — capabilities are always “HABIBCORE [category]”.	
EXAMPLE	“Biscuit AI — a HABIBCORE system” in product footer; discipline chips on case-study index.	
RISKS	Master-brand models dilute product distinctiveness; if a product outgrows the practice, its endorsement may constrain it. Mitigation: the endorsement is contractual, removable, and products keep their own names from day one.	

PART 14 / 17

GUARDRAIL

ANTI-COPYING RULES

How to study other work without becoming it. The identity must stay native to HABIBCORE.

14.1 — PRINCIPLES, NOT RECIPES

References are fuel, not blueprints. When studying any studio, portfolio or product, the only legal export is the **principle** — the reason a device works — never the device itself. “Their case studies convert because every project states the outcome numerically on the first screen” is a transferable principle; copying that studio's three-column hover grid is not. The test: if a competitor could recognise their thinking in HABIBCORE's output, the line was crossed. Layouts, type pairings, colour systems, signature animations and naming conventions observed in the wild are treated as **occupied territory**: noted, understood, then

deliberately answered differently — usually with a fold-angle or dash device that could only come from this mark.

14.2 — REFERENCE PROTOCOL

- 01 **Name the principle:** write one sentence on why the reference works before borrowing any feeling from it.
- 02 **Translate to DNA:** re-express the principle using this system's primitives (plane, dash, keyline, fold, field). If it cannot be translated, it does not belong here.
- 03 **Check the territory:** compare against the three closest known occupants of the device (mentally or in a swipe file); require visible daylight from all three.
- 04 **Sleep on it:** devices that still feel necessary after a week earn implementation; impulses do not.
- 05 **Log the lineage:** experiments influenced by external work are noted in the project's README — honesty keeps influence from curdling into imitation.

14.3 — DISTINCTIVENESS CHECKLIST

Run quarterly against the live site and top applications: (1) Cover the wordmark — is the page still attributable to HABIBCORE from the mark, the metadata rail and the voice alone? (2) Screenshot any screen in greyscale — does it still pass the squint test as this brand? (3) Read three sentences aloud — could an agency template say them? If any check fails, the fix is subtraction back to primitives, never a new coat of styling.

PART 15 / 17

GUARDRAIL

ANTI-SLOP RULES

A standing ban list. Every entry exists because the market is saturated with it — absence of these is itself a brand signal.

15.1 — THE BAN LIST

BANNED	WHY — AND WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES INSTEAD
Purple/blue AI gradients	The uniform of unexamined AI products. Instead: monochrome surfaces; AI work shown as terminals, schemas and product truth.
Glassmorphism excess	Blur-as-depth collapses in print and screenshots. Depth comes from planes, keylines and overlap — physical metaphors, not filters.
Random floating 3-D objects	Rendering without meaning (rejected Direction D). Dimensionality only where the mark's own folds require it, drawn in vector.
Grain / noise overlays	Texture pretending to be craft. Paper tooth is a print-stock decision, never a CSS filter.
Gratuitous glitch effects	Errors are states with recovery paths, not aesthetics.

Decorative code	Terminal screenshots only where code is the artefact; fake syntax as wallpaper is banned. Real code is set in Plex Mono with syntax colour off (one grey, one weight).
Fake technical diagrams	Diagrams must run (system schemas reflect the real architecture). A diagram that explains nothing is deleted in review.
Logo spinning / endless loops	Motion states must mean something (09.1 law 5). Assembly once, then stillness.
"Futuristic" chrome & neon	The future this brand sells is operational, not ornamental — dashboards that work ship the feeling.
Generic brutalism / stock Swiss	Rawness without system is laziness; Swiss grids without a point of view are a template. This system earns its rigour from the mark's own geometry.

15.2 — THE STANDING QUESTION

Every visual decision carries one question in review: “**What does this cost the viewer, and what does it buy?**” If the cost is attention and the purchase is vibes, the element dies. The ban list is not about taste superiority — it is about keeping every surface consistent with the promise that this practice finishes what it starts, including its own design decisions.

PART 16 / 17

GOVERNANCE

DECISION GATES

The twelve questions every major feature must survive, and the classification ledger of every decision made in this document.

16.1 — THE TWELVE QUESTIONS

01 What problem does it solve? 02 Who benefits — client, visitor, or the operator's ego? 03 Does it strengthen the loop (design → build → answer)? 04 Does it improve comprehension? 05 Does it improve recognition? 06 What does it cost to produce? GATES 01-06 · VALUE	07 What does it cost to maintain for five years? 08 Does it scale across digital and physical media? 09 Is it reversible? 10 Is there a simpler solution? 11 Does it add visual noise? 12 Does it make the portfolio harder to use? GATES 07-12 · COST
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A proposal answering 01–05 weakly, or failing 09/10/12, dies regardless of how good it looks in isolation. Classification: **ESSENTIAL** (the system breaks without it) · **HIGH VALUE** (clear return, controlled cost) · **OPTIONAL** (context-dependent, allowed within budgets) · **EXPERIMENTAL** (time-boxed, reversible, in the EXPERIMENTATION layer only) · **REJECTED** (fails the gates; listed so it stays dead).

16.2 — DECISION LEDGER

DECISION	CLASS	ONE-LINE JUSTIFICATION
Retain existing mark unmodified	ESSENTIAL	Distinctive, functional, owned — the fixed asset
Typeset wordmark (Archivo Expanded)	ESSENTIAL	Unifies identity with editorial voice at zero licence cost
Monochrome identity, no decorative accent	ESSENTIAL	Contrast DNA + differentiation; colour buys nothing here
42°/147° angle system	ESSENTIAL	Makes every surface genetically related to the mark
Archivo variable + IBM Plex Mono	ESSENTIAL	Width-fold concept; instrument voice; OFL economics
Dash as universal state device	HIGH VALUE	One primitive covers lists, loading, progress, motion feedback
Signal #FF4B00 (states only)	HIGH VALUE	Solves real state ambiguity; scarcity preserves authority
Motion A (assembly) + B (systemic)	HIGH VALUE	Signature + function, both derived from mark anatomy
Master brand, 8 discipline categories	ESSENTIAL	Concentrates recognition; scales by metadata
Product endorsement model (Biscuit AI, Relay)	HIGH VALUE	Guest names under the flag; reversible spin-out path
Numbered-section site architecture	HIGH VALUE	Already live; engineered-document feel, aids navigation
Case-study 5-plate anatomy (incl. OPERATE)	HIGH VALUE	Makes the follow-through claim comparable and provable
Five-primitive cap on vocabulary	HIGH VALUE	Constraint is the quality controller; blocks ornament drift
Editorial reveals for imagery (C)	OPTIONAL	Use within plates; never the lead motion idea
Kinetic width-fold text transition (E)	OPTIONAL	Display-size entries only; T_TEXTFOLD token
SOUND player & campaign layer	EXPERIMENTAL	Personality burst; time-boxed, insider, removable
Spatial 3-D treatments (D)	REJECTED	Highest cost, weakest fit, slop adjacency
Custom logotype redraw	REJECTED	Competes with the mark; adds maintenance for no gain
Decorative accent colour / gradients	REJECTED	Dilutes the monochrome position
Parallax & scroll-jacking	REJECTED	Noise without state meaning; usability cost

FINAL SYSTEM & ROADMAP

The whole system on one page, then the order of work — what ships first, what follows, and how the system stays honest over time.

17.1 — SYSTEM SUMMARY

REF	LAYER	SPEC IN ONE LINE
A	FOUNDATION	Essence “follow-through”; positioning designer+builder; audience A–D; territory = engineered expression (P01)
B	FOUNDATION	Mark retained; three lockups; 1x clear space; 16 px floor; four sanctioned colour presentations (P02)
C	FOUNDATION → EXPR	DNA: plane, dash, keyline, fold joint, 42° field; angles 42/147; waist notch protected (P03)
D	EXPRESSION	12-col/8 px grid + meta rail; plate/field/ink containers; structural crops; dash-field pattern; mono data-viz; card + transition language (P04)
E	EXPRESSION	Archivo variable (fold by width) + IBM Plex Mono (instrument); seven roles; five typographic laws (P05)
F	EXPRESSION	Ink/Paper/greys + Signal #FF4B00 states-only; surface budget 60-30-G-1; WCAG pairings (P06)
G	EXPRESSION	Evidence-first imagery; 4-step pipeline; casting bans; plates with metadata (P07)
H	EXPRESSION	24-grid icons, 2 px capsule strokes, fold angles, filled=active grammar (P08)
I	EXPRESSION	Motion: A signature + B functional; five physics laws; token table; reduced-motion contract (P09)
J	EXPRESSION	Site as operating system: instrument nav, 5-plate case studies, full interaction inventory (P10)
K	EXPRESSION	Voice: first person, declarative, specific; say/never table; three-question voice test (P11)
L	EXPRESSION	Applications in three tiers; card, covers, social, apparel, signage, docs (P12)
M	FOUNDATION	Branded house; 8 categories as metadata; products endorsed; initiatives time-boxed (P13)
N	GUARDRAIL	Anti-copying protocol: principles not recipes; distinctiveness checklist (P14)
O	GUARDRAIL	Anti-slop ban list + the cost/benefit review question (P15)
P	GOVERNANCE	Twelve gates; classification ledger; REJECTED stays dead (P16)
Q	GOVERNANCE	Usage rules consolidated across parts; this table is the index (P17 + all)
R	GOVERNANCE	Implementation priorities below; quarterly audits (P17)

17.2 — IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

PHASE	SCOPE	WORK	EFFORT
P0 · WEEK 1	Lock the foundation	Produce vector master SVG + PNG set per FIG. 03; favicon/touch icons; asset kit v1 (mark, wordmark, tokens.css); adopt tokens in site stylesheet	2–3 days
P1 · WEEKS 2–3	Site to spec	Apply Part 10: dash loaders, fold transitions, card anatomy + hover, unified 404, Signal budget audit, reduced-motion pass	1–2 weeks
P2 · WEEKS 3–5	Documents & proposals	Proposal/invoice/one-pager templates from this system; case-study 5-plate template; rewrite top 3 case studies into new anatomy	1–2 weeks
P3 · WEEKS 5–7	Identity moments	Business cards (blind deboss), social profile refresh (avatar, post templates), email signature, apparel run, motion endframe film (FIG. 19 produced)	1–2 weeks
P4 · ONGOING	Governance	Quarterly audits: Signal budget, distinctiveness checklist (14.3), decision-ledger review, archive of EXPERIMENTATION outcomes	½ day / quarter

17.3 — HOW THIS SYSTEM EVOLVES

The identity is designed to age by deepening, not redecorating. New work enters through the primitives; new applications are argued through the gates; experiments live and die in the EXPERIMENTATION layer without touching canon. The only three irreversible commitments are the mark, the name, and the follow-through promise — everything else in this manual is confessedly revisable, and the decision ledger (16.2) is where revisions are argued. When in doubt about any future choice, return to the first sentence of this document: one pair of hands, start to ship — and make the surface say exactly that.



DESIGN → BUILD → SYSTEMS → EXECUTION

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6°27'N, 3°24'E — LAGOS, NIGERIA · RESPONDING IN WAT